

Dummit & Foote: Exercises

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0 Preliminaries

0.1 Basics

For Exercises 1 to 4, let

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

and $\mathcal{B} = \{X \in \mathcal{A} : MX = XM\}$, where $\mathcal{A}$ denotes the set of 2×2 matrices with real entries.

(1) Determine which of the following elements of $\mathcal{A}$ lie in $\mathcal{B}$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solution. Note that the 1st matrix is M itself so that it belongs to $\mathcal{B}$, since $MX = XM = M^2$. Further note that the 3rd, 5th, and 6th matrices are the zero, identity, and exchange matrices respectively. Then the 3rd and 5th belong to $\mathcal{B}$ while the 6th does not. Then only the remaining matrices to check are the 2nd and 4th matrices. For the 2nd matrix:

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Then $MX \neq XM$ and the 2nd matrix does not belong to $\mathcal{B}$. For the 4th matrix:

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

So that $MX \neq XM$. □

(2) Prove that if $P, Q \in \mathcal{B}$, then $P + Q \in \mathcal{B}$ where $+$ denotes the usual sum of two matrices.

Solution. For Exercises 2 and 3, let

$$P = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad Q = \begin{pmatrix} e & f \\ g & h \end{pmatrix}, \quad P + Q = \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix}, \quad P \cdot Q = \begin{pmatrix} ae+bg & af+bh \\ ce+dg & cf+dh \end{pmatrix}$$

where $PM = MP$ and $QM = MQ$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} M(P+Q) &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e+c+g & b+f+d+h \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+c & b+d \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} e+g & f+h \\ g & h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= MP + MQ \\ &= PM + QM \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a & a+b \\ c & c+d \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} e & e+f \\ g & g+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e & a+e+b+f \\ c+g & c+g+d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= (P+Q)M \end{aligned}$$

□

- (3) Prove that if $P, Q \in \mathcal{B}$, then $P \cdot Q \in \mathcal{B}$ where $\cdot$ denotes the usual product of two matrices.

Solution. Using PQ , proceed as we did above with $M(PQ)$. Rewriting the entries will result in $(MP)Q$. Since $P \in \mathcal{B}$, then we have $(PM)Q$. We rewrite entries again to result in $P(MQ)$. Because $Q \in \mathcal{B}$, we have $P(QM)$, and a final rewrite results in $(PQ)M$. $\square$

- (4) Find conditions on p, q, r, s which determine precisely when $\begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \in \mathcal{B}$.

Solution. Let X be the matrix described above. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} p+r & q+s \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} p & p+q \\ r & r+s \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Because $X \in \mathcal{B}$, then we may compare entries to obtain the following:

$$\begin{cases} p+r=p \\ q+s=p+q \\ r=r \\ s=r+s \end{cases}$$

The first and fourth equations force $r=0$, and the second equation forces $p=s$. Then $\mathcal{B}$ is classified as

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} p & p+q \\ 0 & p \end{pmatrix} \mid p, q \in \mathbb{R} \right\} \quad \square$$

- (5) Determine whether the following functions f are well defined:

- (a) $f: \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ defined by $f(a/b) = a$.
 (b) $f: \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}$ defined by $f(a/b) = a^2/b^2$.

Solution.

- (a) No, because $1/2 = 2/4$, but $f(1/2) = 1$ and $f(2/4) = 2$.
 (b) Yes; suppose $a/b = c/d$. Then $ad = bc$, or that $a^2d^2 = b^2c^2$. Then $a^2/b^2 = c^2/d^2$, or $f(a/b) = f(c/d)$. $\square$

- (6) Determine whether the function $f: \mathbb{R}^+ \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ defined by mapping a real number r to the first digit to the right of the decimal point in a decimal expansion of r is well defined.

Solution. No. Note that $1 = 1.000\dots = 0.999\dots$, but $f(1.000\dots) = 1$ and $f(0.999\dots) = 9$. $\square$

- (7) Let $f: A \rightarrow B$ be a surjective map of sets. Prove that the relation

$$a \sim b \iff f(a) = f(b)$$

is an equivalence relation whose equivalence classes are the fibers of f .

Solution. The relation above is an equivalence relation, since $=$ is already an equivalence relation on B .

Consider now some $b \in B$. Since f is surjective, there exists $a \in A$ such that $f(a) = b$. The equivalence class of a is the set $\{x \in A \mid x \sim a\}$. By definition of $\sim$, this is equal to the set $\{x \in A \mid f(x) = f(a) = b\}$, which is precisely the fiber of f over b . $\square$

0.2 Properties of the Integers

1. For each of the following pairs of integers a and b , determine their greatest common divisor, their least common multiple, and write their greatest common divisor in the form $ax + by$ for some integers x and y .

- (a) $a = 20, b = 13$
- (b) $a = 69, b = 372$
- (c) $a = 792, b = 275$
- (d) $a = 11391, b = 5673$
- (e) $a = 1761, b = 1567$
- (f) $a = 507885, b = 60808$

Solution.

- (a) Note: for this exercise, we will only do (e) as that has the most steps in calculating both the g.c.d and the Euclidean Algorithm. The l.c.m is obtained by dividing the product ab by (a, b) .

$$(20, 13) = 1, \text{lcm}(20, 13) = 260, 1 = 2(20) - 3(13)$$

$$(b) (69, 372) = 3, \text{lcm}(69, 372) = 8556, 27(69) - 5(372)$$

$$(c) (792, 275) = 11, \text{lcm}(792, 275) = 19800, 8(792) - 23(275)$$

$$(d) (11391, 5673) = 3, \text{lcm}(11391, 5673) = 21540381, 3 = 253(5673) - 126(11391)$$

- (e) Applying the Euclidean Algorithm to $a = 1761$ and $b = 1567$, we get:

$$1761 = (1)1567 + 194$$

$$1567 = (8)194 + 15$$

$$194 = (12)15 + 14$$

$$15 = (1)14 + 1$$

Then $(1761, 1567) = 1$ so that $\text{lcm}(1761, 1567) = 2759487$. Reversing the Euclidean Algorithm steps to solve for 1, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} 1 &= 15 - 14 \\ &= 15 - (194 - 12(15)) = 13(15) - 194 \\ &= 13(1567 - 8(194)) - 194 = 13(1567) - 105(194) \\ &= 13(1567) - 105(1761 - 1567) = -105(1761) + 118(1567) \end{aligned}$$

$$(f) (507885, 60808) = 691, \text{lcm}(507885, 60808) = 44693880, 691 = 142(60808) - 17(507885) \quad \square$$

2. Prove that if the integer k divides the integers a and b then k divides $as + bt$ for every pair of integers s and t .

Solution. Since $k \mid a$ and $k \mid b$, there exists $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $a = kx$ and $b = ky$. Then for any $s, t \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have $as + bt = kxs + kyt = k(xs + yt)$ which is divisible by k . $\square$

3. Prove that if n is composite then there are integers a and b such that n divides ab but n does not divide either a or b .

Solution. By the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic, n has at least two prime factors a, b such that $1 < a, b < n$. Putting $n = ab$, then $n \mid ab$ but $n \nmid a$ and $n \nmid b$. $\square$

4. Let a, b and N be fixed integers with a and b nonzero and let $d = (a, b)$ be the greatest common divisor of a and b . Suppose x_0 and y_0 are particular solutions to $ax + by = N$ (i.e., $ax_0 + by_0 = N$). Prove for any integer t that the integers

$$x = x_0 + \frac{b}{d}t \text{ and } y = y_0 - \frac{a}{d}t$$

are also solutions to $ax + by = N$ (this is in fact the general solution).

Solution. We have

$$\begin{aligned} ax + by &= a\left(x_0 + \frac{b}{d}t\right) + b\left(y_0 - \frac{a}{d}t\right) \\ &= ax_0 + \frac{ab}{d}t + by_0 - \frac{ab}{d}t \\ &= ax_0 + by_0 = N \end{aligned}$$

$\square$

5. Determine the value $\varphi(n)$ each integer $n \leq 30$ where φ denotes the Euler φ -function.

Solution.

n	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
$\varphi(n)$	1	1	2	2	4	2	6	4	6	4	10	4	12	6	8

n	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
$\varphi(n)$	8	16	6	18	8	12	10	22	8	20	12	18	12	28	8

□

6. Prove the Well Ordering Property of $\mathbb{Z}$ by induction and prove the minimal element is unique.

Solution. Let $A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be nonempty. If $0 \in A$, then it has a minimal element. Suppose now that $0 \notin A$. Moreover, suppose that $1, 2, \dots, k \notin A$ for some k . By strong induction, it follows that $k+1 \notin A$. However, this results in there being no positive integer in A , contradicting that it is nonempty, thus it must have a minimal element. Moreover, if it had two minimal elements a, b , then it follows that $a \leq b$ and $b \leq a$ by definition of minimal element. Hence, $a = b$, and the minimal element of A is unique. □

7. If p is a prime, prove that there do not exist nonzero integers a and b such that $a^2 = pb^2$ (i.e., $\sqrt{p}$ is not a rational number).

Solution. Suppose $\sqrt{p}$ is a rational number. Then there exists $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $a^2 = b^2 p$, and $(a, b) = 1$. If $(a, b) = d \neq 1$, then take $a' = a/d$ and $b' = b/d$ instead. Then $p \mid a^2 = a \cdot a$, and $p \mid a$. We then have $a = kp$ for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $b^2 = k^2 p$ so that $p \mid b$, and $b = mp$ for $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. This contradicts that $(a, b) = 1$, hence $\sqrt{p}$ cannot be a rational number. □

8. Let p be a prime, $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Find a formula for the largest power of p which divides $n! = n(n-1)(n-2)\dots 2 \cdot 1$ (it involves the greatest integer function).

Solution. Note that in $n!$, there are $\lfloor n/p \rfloor$ integers that are divisible by p , where the greatest integer function is necessary since n may not be a perfect multiple of p (consider $n = 36$ and $p = 7$. Then there are the multiples 7, 14, 21, 28, and 35 which is $\lfloor 36/7 \rfloor = 5$). However, this alone does not account for the factors of p in $n!$, so we move onto p^2 . In this case, there are $\lfloor n/p^2 \rfloor$ integers divisible by p^2 . We continue this process until a certain integer $a \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $p^a \leq n$. (We must bound p^a above by n , up to equality, since n may be a power of p , and any power a such that $p^a > n$ would result in $\lfloor n/p^a \rfloor = 0$). It then follows that $a \leq \log_p(n)$, or that the maximum power of p (and any of its multiples) that divide $n!$ is given by $a = \lfloor \log_p(n) \rfloor$. Thus, the largest power of p that divides $n!$ is given by

$$\sum_{i=1}^{\lfloor \log_p(n) \rfloor} \left\lfloor \frac{n}{p^i} \right\rfloor$$

□

9. Write a computer program to determine the greatest common divisor (a, b) of two integers a and b and to express (a, b) in the form $ax + by$ for some integers x and y .

Require: Integers a, b (not both zero)

Ensure: Integers g, x, y such that $g = (a, b)$ and $ax + by = g$

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1:  $x_1 \leftarrow 1, y_1 \leftarrow 0$ 
2:  $x_2 \leftarrow 0, y_2 \leftarrow 1$ 
3: while  $b \neq 0$  do
4:    $q \leftarrow 0$ 
5:    $r \leftarrow a$ 
6:   while  $(r \geq b)$  or  $(r \leq -b)$  do
7:      $r \leftarrow r - b$ 
8:      $q \leftarrow q + 1$ 
9:   end while
10:   $a \leftarrow b$ 
11:   $b \leftarrow r$ 

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12:    $(x_1, x_2) \leftarrow (x_2, x_1 - q \times x_2)$ 
13:    $(y_1, y_2) \leftarrow (y_2, y_1 - q \times y_2)$ 
14: end while
15:  $g \leftarrow a$ 
16: return  $(g, x_1, y_1)$ 

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10. Prove for any given positive integer N there exist only finitely many integers n with $\varphi(n) = N$ where φ denotes Euler's φ -function. Conclude in particular that φ tends to infinity as n tends to infinity.

Solution. Let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be fixed, and let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\varphi(n) = N$. We can break apart n into its primes p_i (where $p_1 < p_2 < \dots$) with associated exponents α_i :

$$n = \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\alpha_i} \implies \varphi(n) = \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\alpha_i-1} (p_i - 1) = N$$

In particular, each of the terms $p_i - 1$ divides N so that $p_i - 1 \leq N$, or $p_i \leq N + 1$. It follows that any prime q of some n must be such a prime where $q - 1 \leq N$. Moreover, for some $p_i^{\alpha_i}$ that is a part of n 's prime factorization, it follows that $p_i^{\alpha_i-1}$ divides N . Since $\alpha_i - 1$ is finite, this limits the exponents for any particular p_i . With a finite list of primes and finitely many exponents, it follows that the amount of n such that $\varphi(n) = N$ is finite.

For some $N_0 \in \mathbb{N}$, there are finitely many n such that $\varphi(n) = N_0$. Then there are infinitely many $m > n$ such that $\varphi(m) > N_0$, or that $\varphi(n)$ tends towards infinity. $\square$

11. Prove that if d divides n then $\varphi(d)$ divides $\varphi(n)$ where φ denotes Euler's φ -function.

Solution. Let $n = p_1^{\alpha_1} p_2^{\alpha_2} \dots p_k^{\alpha_k}$ with $d \mid n$. Then d is a composition of some p_i present in n , so some α_i may go to 0 or are less. In particular, we have that $d = p_1^{\beta_1} p_2^{\beta_2} \dots p_k^{\beta_k}$, where $\beta_i \leq \alpha_i$ for all i . To see if $\varphi(d) \mid \varphi(n)$, it follows to check if $p_i^{\beta_i-1} (p_i - 1)$ divides $p_i^{\alpha_i-1} (p_i - 1)$, which further simplifies to checking if $p_i^{\beta_i}$ divides $p_i^{\alpha_i}$ for each i . Clearly, $p_i^{\alpha_i} = p_i^{\beta_i} \cdot p_i^{\alpha_i-\beta_i}$, hence $\varphi(d) \mid \varphi(n)$. $\square$

0.3 $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$: The Integers Modulo n

1. Write down explicitly all the elements in the residue classes of $\mathbb{Z}/18\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}
\bar{0} &= \{0 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{0, 18, -18, 36, -36, \dots\} \\
\bar{1} &= \{1 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{1, 19, -17, 37, -35, \dots\} \\
\bar{2} &= \{2 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{2, 20, -16, 38, -34, \dots\} \\
\bar{3} &= \{3 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{3, 21, -15, 39, -33, \dots\} \\
\bar{4} &= \{4 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{4, 22, -14, 40, -32, \dots\} \\
\bar{5} &= \{5 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{5, 23, -13, 41, -31, \dots\} \\
\bar{6} &= \{6 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{6, 24, -12, 42, -30, \dots\} \\
\bar{7} &= \{7 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{7, 25, -11, 43, -29, \dots\} \\
\bar{8} &= \{8 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{8, 26, -10, 44, -28, \dots\} \\
\bar{9} &= \{9 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{9, 27, -9, 45, -27, \dots\} \\
\bar{10} &= \{10 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{10, 28, -8, 46, -26, \dots\} \\
\bar{11} &= \{11 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{11, 29, -7, 47, -25, \dots\} \\
\bar{12} &= \{12 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{12, 30, -6, 48, -24, \dots\} \\
\bar{13} &= \{13 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{13, 31, -5, 49, -23, \dots\} \\
\bar{14} &= \{14 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{14, 32, -4, 50, -22, \dots\} \\
\bar{15} &= \{15 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{15, 33, -3, 51, -21, \dots\} \\
\bar{16} &= \{16 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{16, 34, -2, 52, -20, \dots\} \\
\bar{17} &= \{17 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{17, 35, -1, 53, -19, \dots\}
\end{aligned}$$

□

2. Prove that the distinct equivalence classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ are precisely $\bar{0}, \bar{1}, \bar{2}, \dots, \overline{n-1}$ (use the Division Algorithm).

Solution. Clearly, $\bar{0}, \bar{1}, \bar{2}, \dots, \overline{n-1} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. Let $\bar{a} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. By the Division Algorithm, there exists $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $0 \leq r < n$ such that $a = nq + r$. Then $a \equiv r \pmod{n}$, so that $\bar{a} = \bar{r}$, where r is any one of the aforementioned equivalence classes. Moreover, if $\bar{a} = \bar{b}$ where $0 \leq a, b < n$, it follows that $n \mid (a - b)$ so that $a - b = 0$, or $a = b$. Hence, the equivalence classes of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ are precisely the set above. □

3. Prove that if $a = a_n 10^n + a_{n-1} 10^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 10 + a_0$ is any positive integer then $a \equiv (a_n + a_{n-1} + \dots + a_1 + a_0) \pmod{9}$ (note that this is the usual arithmetic rule that the remainder after division by 9 is the same as the sum of the decimal digits mod 9—in particular an integer is divisible by 9 if and only if the sum of its digits is divisible by 9) [note that $10 \equiv 1 \pmod{9}$].

Solution. Using the note, then

$$\begin{aligned} a &\equiv (a_n 10^n + a_{n-1} 10^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 10 + a_0) \pmod{9} \\ &\equiv (a_n 1^n + a_{n-1} 1^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 1 + a_0) \pmod{9} \\ &= (a_n + a_{n-1} + \dots + a_1 + a_0) \pmod{9} \end{aligned}$$

□

4. Compute the remainder when 37^{100} is divided by 29.

Solution. Note the following:

$$\begin{aligned} 37^2 &\equiv 6 \pmod{29} \\ 37^4 &\equiv 6^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 7 \pmod{29} \\ 37^8 &\equiv 7^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 20 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{16} &\equiv 20^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 23 \pmod{29} \equiv -6 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{32} &\equiv (-6)^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 7 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{64} &\equiv 20 \pmod{29} \end{aligned}$$

Then we have

$$37^{64} 37^{32} 37^4 \equiv 20 \cdot 7 \cdot 7 \pmod{29} \equiv 20^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 23 \pmod{29}$$

Hence the remainder when dividing 37^{100} by 29 is 23. □

5. Compute the last two digits of 9^{1500} .

Solution. Note that $9^3 \equiv 29 \pmod{100}$ so that $29^3 \equiv 89 \pmod{100}$. Then $89 \cdot 9 \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$, or $9^{10} \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$. Since 1500 is a multiple of 10, then $9^{1500} = (9^{10})^{150} \equiv 1^{150} \pmod{100} \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$. Then the last two digits is 01. □

6. Prove that the square of the elements in $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ are just $\bar{0}$ and $\bar{1}$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} 0^2 &= 0 \equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 1^2 &= 1 \equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 2^2 &= 4 \equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 3^2 &= 9 \equiv 1 \pmod{4} \end{aligned}$$

□

7. Prove that for any integers a and b that $a^2 + b^2$ never leaves a remainder of 3 when divided by 4 (use the previous exercise).

Solution. Since a^2 and b^2 is either 0 mod 4 or 1 mod 4, then we have 4 potential sums:

$$\begin{aligned} 0+0 &\equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 0+1 &\equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 1+0 &\equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 1+1 &\equiv 2 \pmod{4} \end{aligned}$$

In any of the sums, there is no remainder of 3 when dividing by 4. $\square$

8. Prove that the equation $a^2 + b^2 = 3c^2$ has no solutions in nonzero integers a, b and c . [Consider the equation mod 4 as in the previous two exercises and show that a, b and c would all have to be divisible by 2. Then each of a^2, b^2 and c^2 has a factor of 4 and by dividing through by 4 show that there would be a smaller set of solutions to the original equation. Iterate to reach a contradiction.]

Solution. As hinted, consider the equation in mod 4. The left side must be 0 or 1, while the right side must be 0 or 3, hence both sides must be equivalent to 0 mod 4. Then $3c^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$ implies c is even. If a is even, then b is even. If a is odd, then b must be odd. However, putting $a = 2x + 1$ and $b = 2y + 1$ for $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ results in $a^2 + b^2 = (2x+1)^2 + (2y+1)^2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$, contradicting that $a^2 + b^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$. It must be that a and b are even. We may then divide the original equation by 4 to get a new equation $r^2 + s^2 = 3t^2$, where $r < a, s < b, t < c$. But then we may use the same reasoning to conclude that the new r, s, t must also be even, resulting in a new equation with smaller integer solutions. This process cannot be iterated indefinitely as we cannot halve any integer indefinitely and remain an integer. Hence, the original equation does not have integer solutions. $\square$

9. Prove that the square of any odd integer always leaves a remainder of 1 when divided by 8.

Solution. Take $a = 2k + 1, k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $a^2 = 4k^2 + 4k + 1 = 4k(k+1) + 1$. Note that $k(k+1)$ is even, so that $4k(k+1)$ is divisible by 8. Then $a^2 \equiv 1 \pmod{8}$. $\square$

10. Prove that the number of elements of $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is $\varphi(n)$ where φ denotes the Euler φ -function.

Solution. Recall that $\varphi(n)$ produces the number of integers that are relatively prime to n . It suffices to prove that the elements of $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ are the equivalence classes of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ whose representatives are relatively prime to n .

Let $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Then there exists $\bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} = \bar{1}$. In particular, $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} - \bar{1} = \bar{0}$, or $n \mid (ab - 1)$. Then $nx + ab = 1$ for $x \in \mathbb{Z}$, which shows that $(a, n) = 1$. Conversely, if $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $(a, n) = 1$, then there exists $b, x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ab + xn = 1$, or $ab = 1 \pmod{n}$. It follows that $\bar{b}$ is the inverse of $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. $\square$

11. Prove that if $\bar{a}, \bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$, then $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$.

Solution. It follows that there exist $\bar{x}, \bar{y} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{x} = \bar{b} \cdot \bar{y} = \bar{1}$. In particular:

$$\bar{1} = \bar{1} \cdot \bar{1} = (\bar{a} \cdot \bar{x}) \cdot (\bar{b} \cdot \bar{y}) = (\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b}) \cdot (\bar{x} \cdot \bar{y})$$

So that the multiplicative inverse of $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b}$ is $\bar{x} \cdot \bar{y}$. $\square$

12. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}, n > 1$ and let $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $1 \leq a \leq n$. Prove if a and n are not relatively prime, there exists an integer b with $1 \leq b < n$ such that $ab \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$ and deduce that there cannot be an integer c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$.

Solution. Since a and n are not relatively prime, then $(a, n) = d$ where $1 < d \leq a$. Then $n/d, a/d \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $a(n/d) = n(a/d) \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$ so that $b = n/d$. Moreover, if there was such a c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, then $abc \equiv b \pmod{n}$, which is false since $ab \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$. Hence, no such b may exist. $\square$

13. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}, n > 1$ and let $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $1 \leq a \leq n$. Prove that if a and n are relatively prime then there is an integer c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$ [use the fact that the g.c.d. of two integers is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -linear combination of the integers].

Solution. Since $(a, n) = 1$, there exists $c, x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ac + nx = 1$. Then $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$. $\square$

14. Conclude from the previous two exercises that $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is the set of elements $\bar{a}$ of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ with $(a, n) = 1$ and hence prove Proposition 4. Verify this directly in the case $n = 12$.

Solution. The previous two exercises show that a and n are relatively prime if and only if there exists b such that $ab \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, which is exactly the proposition. For $n = 12$, the elements 1, 5, 7, 11 are relatively prime to 12, so that $(\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z})^\times = \{\bar{1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{11}\}$ whose inverses are $\bar{1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{11}$ respectively. $\square$

15. For each of the following pairs of integers a and n , show that a is relatively prime to n and determine the multiplicative inverse of $\bar{a}$ in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$.

- (a) $a = 13, n = 20$
- (b) $a = 69, n = 89$
- (c) $a = 1891, n = 3797$
- (d) $a = 6003722857, n = 77695236973$

Solution.

- (a) Refer to the previous set of exercises on how to do the Euclidean Algorithm and how to calculate such an x such that $ax + by = 1$, or $ax \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$. For this exercise, we obtain $-3 \equiv 17 \pmod{20}$, so the inverse is $\bar{17}$.
 - (b) $40(69) - 31(89) = 1 \implies 40 \cdot 89 \equiv 1 \pmod{89}$, so the inverse is $\bar{40}$.
 - (c) $253(1891) - 126(3797) = 1 \implies 253 \cdot 1891 \equiv 1 \pmod{3797}$, so the inverse is $\bar{253}$.
 - (d) $17n - 220a = 1 \implies -220a \equiv 1 \pmod{n} \implies 77695237193a \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, so the inverse is $\bar{77695237193}$. $\square$
16. Write a computer program to add and multiply mod n , for any n given as input. The output of these operations should be the least residues of the sums and products of two integers. Also include the feature that if $(a, n) = 1$, an integer c between 1 and $n - 1$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{c} = \bar{1}$ may be printed on request. (Your program should not, of course, simply quote "mod" functions already built into many systems).

1 Introduction to Groups

1.1 Basic Axioms and Examples

Let G be a group.

(1) Determine which of the following binary operations are associative:

- (a) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Z}$ defined by $a \star b = a - b$
- (b) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{R}$ defined by $a \star b = a + b + ab$
- (c) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Q}$ defined by $a \star b = \frac{a+b}{5}$
- (d) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$ defined by

$$(a, b) \star (c, d) = (ad + bc, bd)$$

- (e) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Q} - \{0\}$ defined by $a \star b = \frac{a}{b}$

Solution.

- (a) Not associative: $(2-0)-2 \neq 2-(0-2)$.
- (b) Associative:

$$\begin{aligned} (a \star b) \star c &= (a + b + ab) \star c \\ &= (a + b + ab) + c + (a + b + ab)c \\ &= a + b + ab + c + ac + bc + abc \\ &= a + b + c + bc + ab + ac + abc \\ &= a + (b + c + bc) + a(b + c + bc) \\ &= a \star (b + c + bc) \\ &= a \star (b \star c) \end{aligned}$$

- (c) Not associative: $(1 \star 0) \star 2 = 11/25, 1 \star (0 \star 2) = 7/25$.
- (d) Associative:

$$\begin{aligned} [(a, b) \star (c, d)] \star (e, f) &= (ad + bc, bd) \star (e, f) \\ &= ((ad + bc)f + bde, bdf) \\ &= (adf + bcf + bde, bdf) \\ &= (adf + b(cf + de), bdf) \\ &= (a, b) \star (cf + de, df) \\ &= (a, b) \star [(c, d) \star (e, f)] \end{aligned}$$

- (e) Not associative: $(1 \star 2) \star 3 = 1/6, 1 \star (2 \star 3) = 3/2$. □

(2) Decide which of the binary operations in the preceding exercise are commutative.

Solution.

- (a) Not commutative: $1 - 0 \neq 0 - 1$.
- (b) Commutative: $a \star b = a + b + ab = b + a + ba = b \star a$.
- (c) Commutative: $a \star b = (a + b)/5 = (b + a)/5 = b \star a$.
- (d) Commutative: $(a, b) \star (c, d) = (ad + bc, bd) = (cb + da, db) = (c, d) \star (a, b)$.
- (e) Not commutative: $1/2 \neq 2/1$. □

(3) Prove that addition of residue classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is associative (you may assume it is well defined).

Solution. Let $\bar{a}, \bar{b}, \bar{c} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. Then $(\bar{a} + \bar{b}) + \bar{c} = \overline{a + b} + \bar{c} = \overline{(a + b) + c} = \overline{a + (b + c)} = \bar{a} + \overline{b + c} = \bar{a} + (\bar{b} + \bar{c})$. □

(4) Prove that multiplication of residue classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is associative (you may assume it is well defined).

Solution. Uses similar reasoning as the previous exercise (where $\cdot$ is associative over $\mathbb{Z}$). $\square$

- (5) Prove for all $n > 1$ that $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is not a group under multiplication of residue classes.

Solution. Note that in any $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$, $\bar{1}$ is a multiplicative identity. Moreover, there is no $x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $0x = 1$ so that $\bar{0} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ has no multiplicative inverse. $\square$

- (6) Determine which of the following sets are groups under addition:

- (a) the set of rational numbers (including $0 = 0/1$) in lowest terms whose denominators are odd
- (b) the set of rational numbers (including $0 = 0/1$) in lowest terms whose denominators are even
- (c) the set of rational numbers of absolute value < 1
- (d) the set of rational numbers of absolute value ≥ 1 together with 0
- (e) the set of rational numbers with denominators equal to 1 or 2
- (f) the set of rational numbers with denominators equal to 1, 2, or 3

Solution. Let S denote the set in each part.

- (a) Clearly, $0 \in S$ and for any $r \in S$, then $-r \in S$ is the additive inverse. To prove closure, let $a/b, c/d \in S$, and consider its sum $(ad+bc)/bd$. Since b, d are odd, then bd is also odd. Since having an even factor results in an even number, then any divisor of bd must also be odd. Then $(ad+bc, bd)$ must also be odd, and if we divide both the numerator and the denominator by this quantity, then we still result in odd numbers. Hence, A is closed under addition and is a group.
 - (b) S is not a group, since $1/2 \in S$, but $1/2 + 1/2 = 2/2 = 1/1 \notin S$.
 - (c) Same as previous.
 - (d) S is not a group, since $3/2, 1 \in S$, but $3/2 - 1 = 1/2 \notin S$.
 - (e) Using the Division Algorithm, any $p \in S$ may be split into the form $a + b/2$, where a is even and b is either 0 (if the numerator p is even) or 1 (if the numerator of p is odd). Then if we have $a_1 + b_1/2, a_2 + b_2/2 \in S$ and we consider their sum, then either both b_i is 0 or 1, in which case we remain an integer with denominator 1, or just one of the b_i is 1 in which case we end with a rational with denominator 2 (WLOG, suppose $b_1 = 1$ and $b_2 = 0$. Then we get the rational $(2a_1 + 2a_2 + 1)/2$). Hence, S is closed under addition, and it also has identity 0 and additive inverse $-p$ so that S is a group.
 - (f) S is not a group, since $1/2, 1/3 \in S$, but $1/2 + 1/3 = 5/6 \notin S$. $\square$
- (7) Let $G = \{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid 0 \leq x < 1\}$ and for $x, y \in G$ let $x \star y$ be the fractional part of $x + y$ (i.e., $x \star y = x + y - [x + y]$ where $[a]$ is the greatest integer less than or equal to a). Prove that $\star$ is a well defined binary operation on G and that G is an abelian group under $\star$ (called the *real numbers mod 1*).

Solution. Let $x, y \in G$. Then we have two cases:

- $0 \leq x + y < 1$: Then $[x + y] = 0$, and $x \star y = x + y \in G$,
 - $1 \leq x + y < 2$: Then $[x + y] = 1$, and $x \star y = x + y - 1 \in G$.
- so that $\star$ is well defined on G . To show associativity, let $z \in G$. Then there are three cases:
- If $0 \leq x + y, y + z < 1$, then $[x + y] = [y + z] = 0$:

$$\begin{aligned} (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\ &= x + y + z - [x + y + z] \\ &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\ &= x \star (y \star z) \end{aligned}$$

- If $1 \leq x + y, y + z < 2$, then $[x + y] = [y + z] = 1$:

$$\begin{aligned} (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\ &= (x + y - 1) + z - [x + y - 1 + z] \\ &= x + (y + z - 1) - [x + y + z - 1] \\ &= x \star (y + z - 1) - [x + (y + z - 1)] \\ &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\ &= x \star (y \star z) \end{aligned}$$

- If $1 \leq x + y < 2$ and $0 \leq y + z < 1$, then $[x + y] = 1$ and $[y + z] = 0$. The case of $0 \leq x + y < 1$ and $1 \leq y + z < 2$ is similar:

$$\begin{aligned}
 (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\
 &= (x + y - 1) + z - [x + y - 1 + z] \\
 &= x + y - 1 + z - ([x + y + z] - 1) \\
 &= x + y + z - 1 - [x + y + z] + 1 \\
 &= x + y + z - [x + y + z] \\
 &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\
 &= x \star (y \star z)
 \end{aligned}$$

Then $\star$ is associative. Moreover, commutativity of regular addition implies commutativity of G . For the identity element, note that $0 \in G$ and $0 \star x = x + 0 - [x] = x$. To determine the inverse of some $x \in G$, suppose $w \in G$ such that $x \star w = 0$. Then $x + w - [x + w] = 0$. Note that $0 \leq x + w < 2$, so $[x + w] = 0$ or 1 . If $[x + w] = 0$, then $w = -x$. Since $w, x \in G$, then this is when $x = w = 0$. If $[x + w] = 1$, then $w = 1 - x$ for $0 < x < 1$. Hence, G is closed under inverses and is a group. $\square$

- (8) Let $G = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : z^n = 1 \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$.

- Prove that G is a group under multiplication (called the group of roots of unity in $\mathbb{C}$).
- Prove that G is not a group under addition.

Solution.

- Note that $1 \in G$, so G has an identity. Moreover, if $zz^{-1} = 1$ for some $z \in G$, then $z^{-1} = 1/z \in G$ because $(1/z)^n = 1/z^n = 1$. Lastly, let $z, w \in G$, where $z^n = 1$ and $w^m = 1$ for $n, m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then

$$(zw)^{mn} = (z^n)^m (w^m)^n = 1$$

so that $zw \in G$. Moreover, multiplication is associative in G since $G \subseteq \mathbb{C}$.

- Note that $1, -1 \in G$, but $1 + (-1) = 0 \notin G$, since there is no n such that $0^n = 1$. $\square$

- (9) Let $G = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \in \mathbb{R} : a, b \in \mathbb{Q}\}$.

- Prove that G is a group under addition.
- Prove that the nonzero elements of G are a group under multiplication. [“Rationalize the denominators” to find multiplicative inverses.]

Solution.

- Since $0 + 0\sqrt{2} = 0 \in G$, then G has an identity. Moreover, for any $a + b\sqrt{2} \in G$, it has inverse $-a - b\sqrt{2} \in G$. Associativity in G follows from associativity in $\mathbb{R}$, and for $a + b\sqrt{2}, c + d\sqrt{2} \in G$, we have $(a + b\sqrt{2}) + (c + d\sqrt{2}) = (a + c) + (b + d)\sqrt{2}$, where $a + b, c + d \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that it is closed under addition. Hence, G is a group.
- Since $1 + 0\sqrt{2} = 1 \in G$, then G has identity. Moreover, for $a + b\sqrt{2}$, we take:

$$\frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{a - b\sqrt{2}}{a - b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{a - b\sqrt{2}}{a^2 - 2b^2} = \frac{a}{a^2 - 2b^2} - \frac{b}{a^2 - 2b^2} \sqrt{2}$$

where $a^2 - 2b^2 \neq 0$ (otherwise, then $a/b = \pm\sqrt{2}$, which is impossible). Then G is closed under inverses. Associativity in G follows from associativity of multiplication in $\mathbb{R}$, and for $a + b\sqrt{2}, c + d\sqrt{2} \in G$, we have $(a + b\sqrt{2})(c + d\sqrt{2}) = (ac + 2bd) + (ad + bc)\sqrt{2}$ where $ac + 2bd, ad + bc \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that G is closed under multiplication. Then G is a group. $\square$

- (10) Prove that a finite group is abelian if and only if its group table is a symmetric matrix.

Solution. Let G be a finite group with elements $g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n$ for finite n and $g_1 = 1$. Then G is abelian if and only if $g_i g_j = g_j g_i$ for any i, j if and only if the group table is a symmetric matrix. $\square$

- (11) Find the orders of each element of the additive group $\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution. For each $\bar{x} \in \mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z}$, add it to itself until we arrive at $\bar{0}$. $|\bar{0}| = 1$, and $\bar{1} = 12$ since $12 \cdot \bar{1} = \bar{12} = \bar{0}$. In particular, we have:

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{0}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{2}$	$\bar{3}$	$\bar{4}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{6}$	$\bar{7}$	$\bar{8}$	$\bar{9}$	$\bar{10}$	$\bar{11}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	12	6	4	3	12	2	12	3	4	6	12

□

- (12) Find the orders of the following elements of the multiplicative group $(\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z})^\times$: $\bar{1}, \bar{-1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{-7}, \bar{13}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{7}$	$\bar{-7}$	$\bar{13}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	2	2	2	2	1

□

- (13) Find the orders of the following elements of the additive group $\mathbb{Z}/36\mathbb{Z}$: $\bar{1}, \bar{2}, \bar{6}, \bar{9}, \bar{10}, \bar{12}, \bar{-1}, \bar{-10}, \bar{-18}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{2}$	$\bar{6}$	$\bar{9}$	$\bar{10}$	$\bar{12}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{-10}$	$\bar{-18}$
$ \bar{x} $	36	18	6	4	18	3	36	18	2

□

- (14) Find the orders of the following elements of the multiplicative group $(\mathbb{Z}/36\mathbb{Z})^\times$: $\bar{1}, \bar{-1}, \bar{5}, \bar{13}, \bar{-13}, \bar{17}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{13}$	$\bar{-13}$	$\bar{17}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	2	6	3	6	2

□

- (15) Prove that $(a_1 a_2 \dots a_n)^{-1} = a_n^{-1} a_{n-1}^{-1} \dots a_1^{-1}$ for all $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in G$.

Solution. For $n = 1$, the result follows. Suppose it holds for $n = k \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. For $n = k + 1$, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k a_{k+1})^{-1} &= (a_{k+1}^{-1} a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) = (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k) (a_{k+1} a_{k+1}^{-1}) (a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) \\ &= (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k)^{-1} (a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

The result follows by induction.

□

- (16) Let x be an element of G . Prove that $x^2 = 1$ if and only if $|x|$ is either 1 or 2.

Solution. If $x^2 = 1$, then $|x| \leq 2$. Then $|x| = 1$ or 2. If $|x| = 1$, then $x = 1$, and $x^2 = 1^2 = 1$. If $|x| = 2$, then $x^2 = 1$.

□

- (17) Let x be an element of G . Prove that if $|x| = n$ for some positive integer n , then $x^{-1} = x^{n-1}$.

Solution. Note that $x^n = x^{n-1} x = 1$. Then $x^{n-1} = x^{-1}$.

□

- (18) Let x, y be elements of G . Prove that $xy = yx$ if and only if $y^{-1}xy = x$ if and only if $x^{-1}y^{-1}xy = 1$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} xy &= yx \\ y^{-1}xy &= y^{-1}yx \\ y^{-1}xy &= x \\ x^{-1}y^{-1}xy &= x^{-1}x \\ x^{-1}y^{-1}xy &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

□

(19) Let $x \in G$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}^+$.

- (a) Prove that $x^{a+b} = x^a x^b$ and $(x^a)^b = x^{ab}$.
- (b) Prove that $(x^a)^{-1} = x^{-a}$.
- (c) Establish part (a) for arbitrary integers a and b (positive, negative, or zero).

Solution.

- (a) Since x^a has a amount of x and x^b has b amount of x , and x^{a+b} has $a+b$ amount of x , the result follows. Similarly, b amount of x^a means there are ab amount of x , or x^{ab} .
- (b) Note that $x^{-a} = (x^{-1})^a$. For $a = 1$, this follows. Suppose $(x^a)^{-1} = (x^{-1})^a$ for $a = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then for $a = n+1$, we have $(x^{-1})^{n+1} = (x^{-1})^n x^{-1} = (x^{-1})^n x^{-1} = 1$, which is true by the inductive hypothesis.
- (c) The case where both a and b are positive is done. If $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $b = 0$, then $x^{a+0} = x^a x^0 = x^a$. Moreover, we have $(x^a)^0 = 1$ by definition, so $x^{a \cdot 0} = x^0 = 1$. If $a > 0$ and $b < 0$, we have two cases for the first part of (a):
 - If $a+b > 0$, then $x^a = x^{a+b-b} = x^{a+b} x^{-b}$. Then $x^a x^b = x^{a+b}$.
 - If $a+b < 0$, then $x^b = (x^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-(a+b)+a})^{-1} = (x^{-(a+b)} x^a)^{-1} = (x^a)^{-1} (x^{-(a+b)})^{-1} = x^{-a} x^{a+b}$. Then $x^a x^b = x^{a+b}$.
 For the second part of (a), we have $(x^a)^b = ((x^a)^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-ab})^{-1} = x^{ab}$. Next, the case of $a < 0$ and $b > 0$ is similar. Lastly, if $a < 0$ and $b < 0$, then $x^{a+b} = (x^{-b-a})^{-1} = (x^{-b} x^{-a})^{-1} = (x^{-a})^{-1} (x^{-b})^{-1} = x^a x^b$. Additionally, $(x^a)^b = ((x^a)^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-ab})^{-1} = ((x^{ab})^{-1})^{-1} = x^{ab}$. $\square$

(20) For x an element in G , show that x and x^{-1} have the same order.

Solution. Let $|x| = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $(x^{-1})^n = (x^n)^{-1} = 1^{-1} = 1$, so $|x^{-1}| \leq |x|$. If $|x^{-1}| = m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, then $x^m = (x^{-1})^{-m} = ((x^{-1})^m)^{-1} = 1^{-1} = 1$, so $|x| \leq |x^{-1}|$. Hence, $n = m$. This establishes that the orders are the same if it is finite; otherwise, both $|x|$ and $|x^{-1}|$ must be of infinite order. $\square$

(21) Let G be a finite group and let x be an element of order n . Prove that if n is odd, then $x = (x^2)^k$ for some $k \geq 1$.

Solution. Put $n = 2k - 1$ for $k \geq 1$. Then $1 = x^n = x^{2k-1} = (x^2)^k x^{-1}$. The result follows. $\square$

(22) If x and g are elements of the group G , prove that $|x| = |g^{-1}xg|$. Deduce that $|ab| = |ba|$ for all $a, b \in G$.

Solution. We first prove that $(g^{-1}xg)^n = g^{-1}x^n g$ by induction. For $n = 1$, the result is clear. Supposing it is true for some $n = k$, then for $n = k+1$, we have $(g^{-1}xg)^{k+1} = (g^{-1}xg)^k (g^{-1}xg) = (g^{-1}x^k g)(g^{-1}xg) = g^{-1}x^{k+1}g$.

Put $|x| = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $(g^{-1}xg)^n = g^{-1}x^n g = g^{-1}1g = 1$ so that $|g^{-1}xg| \leq n$. Similarly, put $|g^{-1}xg| = m$. Then $1 = (g^{-1}xg)^m = g^{-1}x^m g$. Then $1 = x^m$ so that $|x| \leq m$, hence $|x| = |g^{-1}xg|$. Similar to the previous exercise, then both must be of finite or infinite order. Finally, for $a, b \in G$, we have $|ab| = |b(ab)^{-1}| = |ba|$. $\square$

(23) Suppose $x \in G$ and $|x| = n < \infty$. If $n = st$ for some positive integers s and t , prove that $|x^s| = t$.

Solution. Let $|x^s| = r$. Since $1 = x^n = x^{st} = (x^s)^t$, then $|x^s| \leq t$. Moreover, we have $(x^s)^r = x^{sr} = 1$ so that $|x| = st \leq sr$. Then $t \leq |x^s|$. $\square$

(24) If a and b are commuting elements of G , prove that $(ab)^n = a^n b^n$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. [Do this by induction for positive n first.]

Solution. The case for $n = 1$ is clear. Supposing the result holds for $n = k$, then for $n = k+1$, we have $(ab)^{k+1} = (ab)^k (ab) = a^k b^k ab = a^{k+1} b^{k+1}$. The result for $n = 0$ is trivial, and for $n < 0$, we have $(ab)^n = (ba)^n = ((ba)^{-n})^{-1} = (b^{-n} a^{-n})^{-1} = a^n b^n$. $\square$

(25) Prove that if $x^2 = 1$ for all $x \in G$, then G is abelian.

Solution. Note that $x^2 = 1$ implies $x = x^{-1}$ for any $x \in G$. Then for $a, b \in G$, we have that $ab = (ab)^{-1} = b^{-1} a^{-1} = ba$. $\square$

(26) Assume H is a nonempty subset of $(G, \star)$ which is closed under the binary operation on G and is closed under inverses, i.e., for all $h, k \in H$, $hk, h^{-1} \in H$. Prove that H is a group under the operation $\star$ restricted to H (such a subset H is called a *subgroup* of G).

Solution. Since $hk, h^{-1} \in H$, then H has existence of inverse and closure. Moreover, $\star$ is associative in H due to associativity in G . Lastly, there exists $h \in H$ since it is nonempty. Then $h^{-1} \in H$ so that $hh^{-1} = 1 \in H$. Hence, $(H, \star)$ is a group. $\square$

- (27) Prove that if x is an element of the group G , then $\{x^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is a subgroup. (cf. the preceding exercise) of G (called the *cyclic subgroup* of G generated by x).

Solution. Let $x^m, x^n \in G$. Then $x^m x^n = x^{m+n} \in G$ since $m+n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Moreover, $x^{-n} \in G$ since $-n \in \mathbb{Z}$ so that the set has an inverse. Additionally, $x^0 = 1$ is in the set. Then the set is a subgroup of G . $\square$

- (28) Let $(A, \star)$ and $(B, \diamond)$ be groups and let $A \times B$ be their direct product (as defined in Example 6). Verify all the group axioms for $A \times B$:

(a) Prove that the associative law holds:

$$\text{for all } (a_1, b_1), (a_2, b_2), (a_3, b_3) \in A \times B, [(a_1, b_1)(a_2, b_2)](a_3, b_3) = (a_1, b_1)[(a_2, b_2)(a_3, b_3)]$$

(a) Prove that $(1, 1)$ is the identity of $A \times B$, and

(b) Prove that the inverse of (a, b) is (a^{-1}, b^{-1}) .

Solution.

(a) Let $(a_1, b_1), (a_2, b_2), (a_3, b_3) \in A \times B$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} [(a_1, b_1)(a_2, b_2)](a_3, b_3) &= (a_1 a_2, b_1 b_2)(a_3, b_3) \\ &= ((a_1 a_2) a_3, (b_1 b_2) b_3) \\ &= (a_1 (a_2 a_3), b_1 (b_2 b_3)) \\ &= (a_1, b_1)(a_2 a_3, b_2 b_3) \\ &= (a_1, b_1)[(a_2, b_2)(a_3, b_3)] \end{aligned}$$

(b) For $a \in A, b \in B$, we have $(a, b)(1, 1) = (a \star 1, b \diamond 1) = (a, b)$.

(c) We have $(a, b)(a^{-1}, b^{-1}) = (a \star a^{-1}, b \diamond b^{-1}) = (1, 1)$. $\square$

- (29) Prove that $A \times B$ is an abelian group if and only if both A and B are abelian.

Solution. Let $a, a' \in A$ and $b, b' \in B$. Suppose $A \times B$ is abelian. Then

$$(aa', bb') = (a, b)(a', b') = (a', b')(a, b) = (a'a, b'b)$$

so that A and B are abelian. If A and B are both abelian, then

$$(a, b)(a', b') = (aa', bb') = (a'a, b'b) = (a', b')(a, b)$$

hence $A \times B$ is abelian. $\square$

- (30) Prove that the elements $(a, 1)$ and $(1, b)$ of $A \times B$ commute and deduce that the order of (a, b) is the least common multiple of $|a|$ and $|b|$.

Solution. We have $(a, 1)(1, b) = (a1, 1b) = (1a, b1) = (1, b)(a, 1)$. Let $\ell = \text{lcm}(|a|, |b|)$ so that $\ell = m|a| = n|b|$ for $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Put $|(a, b)| = k$. Since $(a, b)^k = (a^k, b^k) = (1, 1)$, then $|a|$ and $|b|$ must divide k so that $\ell \leq k$. Moreover, we have $(a, b)^\ell = (a^\ell, b^\ell) = (a^{m|a|}, b^{n|b|}) = (1^m, 1^n) = (1, 1)$ so that $k \leq \ell$. The result follows. $\square$

- (31) Prove that any finite group G of even order contains an element of order 2. [Let $t(G)$ be the set $\{g \in G \mid g \neq g^{-1}\}$.] Show that $t(G)$ has an even number of elements and every nonidentity element of $G - t(G)$ has order 2.]

Solution. Note that if $g \in G$, then $g^{-1} \in G$ so that the elements of $t(G)$ come in pairs. Then $|t(G)|$ is even, and $|G - t(G)|$ is also even. Moreover, $1 \notin t(G)$ since $1^{-1} = 1$. Then $1 \in G - t(G)$ so that it is nonempty, and there must exist $h \in G - t(G)$ such that $h = h^{-1}$ and $h \neq 1$ (because $|G - t(G)| \geq 2$). Then $h^2 = 1$. $\square$

- (32) If x is an element of finite order n in G , prove that the elements $1, x, x^2, \dots, x^{n-1}$ are all distinct. Deduce that $|x| \leq |G|$.

Solution. Suppose x^a, x^b are not distinct for $1 \leq a < b < n$. Then $x^{b-a} = 1$. But then $b-a < n$, contradicting that $|x| = n$. It follows that $|x| \leq |G|$. $\square$

(33) Let x be an element of finite order in G .

- (a) Prove that if n is odd then $x^i \neq x^{-i}$ for all $i = 1, 2, \dots, n-1$.
- (b) Prove that if $n = 2k$ and $1 \leq i < n$ then $x^i = x^{-i}$ if and only if $i = k$.

Solution.

- (a) Let $i \leq n$. Then $x^i x^{n-i} = 1$ and $x^{-i} = x^{n-i}$. By Exercise (32), then $x^i \neq x^{n-i}$ when $i \neq n-i$. Then $x^i \neq x^{-i}$. For odd n , certainly $i \neq i$ so the result follows.
- (b) For $1 \leq i < n$ where $i \neq k$, then $i \neq n-i$ so that $x^i \neq x^{n-i}$ by the previous part. Moreover, if $i = k$, then $x^i x^i = 1$ and $x^i = x^{-i}$. $\square$

(34) If x is an element of infinite order in G , prove that the elements $x^n, n \in \mathbb{Z}$ are all distinct.

Solution. Suppose $x^m = x^n$ for $m \neq n$. Then $x^{m-n} = 1$, which is a contradiction. $\square$

(35) If x is an element of finite order in G , use the Division Algorithm to show that any integral power of x equals one of the elements in the set $\{1, x, x^2, \dots, x^{n-1}\}$ (so these are all the distinct elements of the cyclic subgroup (cf. Exercise 27 above) of G generated by x).

Solution. Let $x^k \in G$ and $|x| = n$. Then $k = nq + r$ for $0 \leq r < n$ and $q \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $x^k = x^{nq+r} = x^{nq} x^r = 1 x^r = x^r$. $\square$

(36) Assume $G = \{1, a, b, c\}$ is a group of order 4 with identity 1. Assume also that G has no elements of order 4 (so by Exercise 32, every element has order ≤ 3). Use the cancellation laws to show that there is a unique group table for G . Deduce that G is abelian.

Solution. Since no element has order 4, then each of the elements must have order 2. Now consider ab (without loss of generality; we may use bc or ac). If $ab = 1$, then $a = b^{-1}$, which cannot be true since $b = b^{-1}$ because $b^2 = 1$. Moreover, $ab \neq a$ since $b \neq 1$. Similarly, $ab \neq b$. It must be that $ab = c$. Moreover, $a^2 b = ac$ so that $ba^{-1} = ac a^{-1} = a(ab)a = ba$. Using similar reasoning, we deduce that $bc = cb = a$ and $ac = ca = b$. Then we have the group table:

$\cdot$	1	a	b	c
1	1	a	b	c
a	a	1	c	b
b	b	c	1	a
c	c	b	a	1

$\square$

1.2 Dihedral Groups

In these exercises, D_{2n} has the usual presentation $D_{2n} = \langle r, s \mid r^n = s^2 = 1, rs = sr^{-1} \rangle$.

(1) Compute the order of each of the elements in the following groups:

- (a) D_6
- (b) D_8
- (c) D_{10}

Solution. Note that for any sr^k for $1 \leq k \leq n-1$, we have $(sr^k)(sr^k) = s(r^k s)r^k = s(sr^{-k})r^k = s^2 = 1$ so that $|sr^k| = 2$. All that's left for the rest of the exercises is to calculate the order of the rotations:

- (a) $D_6 = \{1, r, r^2, s, sr, sr^2\}$. Then $|1| = 1$ and $|r| = |r^2| = 2$.
- (b) $D_8 = \{1, r, r^2, r^3, s, sr, sr^2, sr^3\}$. Then $|1| = 1, |r^2| = 2$ and $|r| = |r^3| = 4$.
- (c) $D_{10} = \{1, r, r^2, r^3, r^4, s, sr, sr^2, sr^3, sr^4\}$. Then $|1| = 1$ and $|r| = |r^2| = |r^3| = |r^4| = 5$. $\square$

- (2) Use the generators and relations above to show that if x is any element of D_{2n} which is not a power of r , then $rx = xr^{-1}$.

Solution. If $x \neq r^k$, then $x = sr^k$. Then $r(sr^k) = (sr^{-1})r^k = sr^k r^{-1}$. $\square$

- (3) Use the generators and relations above to show that every element of D_{2n} which is not a power of r has order 2. Deduce that D_{2n} is generated by the two elements s and sr , both of which have order 2. [cf. Exercise 33 of Section 1.]

Solution. See Exercise (1) from this section for the solution to the first part. For any $r^i \in D_{2n}$, then $(s(sr))^i = s^i r^i$, and for any $sr^i \in D_{2n}$, then $s(s(sr))^i = sr^i$ so that D_{2n} is generated by $\{s, sr\}$. $\square$

- (4) If $n = 2k$ is even and $n \geq 4$, show that $z = r^k$ is an element of order 2 which commutes with all elements of D_{2n} . Show also that z is the only nonidentity element of D_{2n} which commutes with all elements of D_{2n} . [cf. Exercise 33 of Section 1.]

Solution. Clearly $r^k \neq 1$, and $(r^k)^2 = r^n = 1$ so that $|r^k| = 2$. Noting that $r^k = r^{-k}$ since $r^{2k} = 1$, then for any $s^i r^j$ where $i \in \{0, 1\}$ and $1 \leq j \leq n-1$, then $(s^i r^j)r^k = (s^i r^k)r^j = (r^{-k} s^i)r^j = r^k(s^i r^j)$ so that r^k commutes with any element.

Suppose now that there existed a nonidentity element $w \in D_{2n}$ that commutes with every element of D_{2n} . In particular, w must commute with s , i.e., $sw = ws$. There are two cases to discuss:

- If $w = r^t$ for some $t \in \mathbb{Z}$, then $sw = sr^t$ and $ws = r^t s$. Then $sr^t = r^t s$, or $sr^t = sr^{-t}$, implying that $t = k$ by Section 1, Exercise (33).
- If $w = sr^t$, then $sw = sr^t$ and $ws = r^{-t}$, implying that $t = 0$ or $t = k$. Then $w = s$ or $w = sr^k$. Since s does not commute with r , then that cannot be. If $w = sr^k$, then $sr^{k+1} = rsr^k = sr^{k-1}$, or that $k = 2$, contradicting that $n \geq 4$. Hence, it follows that w cannot be a reflection.

Then $w = r^k = z$, making it unique. $\square$

- (5) If n is odd and $n \geq 3$, show that the identity is the only element of D_{2n} which commutes with all elements of D_{2n} . [cf. Exercise 33 of Section 1.]

Solution. Use the odd case in Section 1, Exercise (33). $\square$

- (6) Let x and y be elements of order 2 in any group G . Prove that if $t = xy$, then $tx = xt^{-1}$ (so that if $n = |xy| < \infty$ then x, y satisfy the same relations in G as s, r do in D_{2n}).

Solution. Note that $|x| = |y| = 2$, so $x = x^{-1}$ and $y = y^{-1}$. Then $tx = xyx = xy^{-1}x^{-1} = xt^{-1}$. $\square$

- (7) Show that $\langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^n = 1 \rangle$ gives a presentation for D_{2n} in terms of the two generators a and b of order 2 computed in Exercise 3 above. [Show that the relations for r and s follow from the relations for a and b and conversely, the relations for a and b follow from those for r and s .]

Solution. Suppose $a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^n = 1$. The first natural choice is to let $a = s$ so that $s^2 = 1$. The next one is that $ab = r$ so that $r^n = 1$. Since $sb = r$, then $b = s^{-1}r = sr$. Moreover, $sr = b = b^{-1} = r^{-1}s^{-1} = r^{-1}s$ so that we have the regular presentation of D_{2n} .

Using the regular representation, then $a^2 = s^2 = 1$ and $b^2 = sr sr = ssr^{-1}r = 1$. Moreover, we have $(ab)^n = (s(sr))^n = r^n = 1$, and we have the resulting presentation. $\square$

- (8) Find the order of the cyclic subgroup of D_{2n} generated by r (cf. Exercise 27 of Section I).

Solution. Let $G = \langle r \rangle$ be the cyclic subgroup of D_{2n} generated by r . Clearly $\{1, r, r^2, \dots, r^{n-1}\} \subseteq G$ so that $|G| \geq n$. Moreover, for $r^k \in G$, we may use the division algorithm to write $k = nq + x$ for $0 \leq x < n$, and $r^k = r^{nq+x} = (r^n)^q r^x = r^x$, where r^x is any one of the elements in G by definition. Then $G \subseteq \{1, r, r^2, \dots, r^{n-1}\}$ so that $|G| = n$. $\square$

In each of Exercises 9 to 13 you can find the order of the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ (also called the group of rotations) of the given Platonic solid by following the proof for the order of D_{2n} : find the number of positions to which an adjacent pair of vertices can be sent. Alternatively, you can find the number of places to which a given face may be sent and, once a face is fixed, the number of positions to which a vertex on that face may be sent.

- (9) Let G be the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of a tetrahedron. Show that $|G| = 12$.

Solution. Label the vertices of a tetrahedron 1 through 4 so that vertex 1 has 4 choices. Then vertex 2 has 3 remaining choices, and vertex 3 and 4 are determined after. It follows that $4(3) = 12$ symmetries. $\square$

- (10) Let G be the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of a cube. Show that $|G| = 24$.

Solution. 8 choices for vertex 1 and 3 adjacent vertices for vertex 2; $8(3) = 24$ symmetries. $\square$

- (11) Let G be the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of an octahedron. Show that $|G| = 24$.

Solution. 6 choices for vertex 1 and 4 adjacent vertices for vertex 2; $6(4) = 24$ symmetries. $\square$

- (12) Let G be the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of a dodecahedron. Show that $|G| = 60$.

Solution. 20 choices for vertex 1 and 3 adjacent vertices for vertex 2; $20(3) = 60$ symmetries. $\square$

- (13) Let G be the group of rigid motions in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of an icosahedron. Show that $|G| = 60$.

Solution. 12 choices for vertex 1 and 5 adjacent vertices for vertex 2; $12(5) = 60$ symmetries. $\square$

- (14) Find a set of generators for $\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution. Any integer is of the form $n1$, so $\mathbb{Z} = \langle 1 \rangle$. $\square$

- (15) Find a set of generators and relations for $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution. Each element of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is of the form $k\bar{1}$ for $0 \leq k < n$. Then $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} = \langle \bar{1} \mid n\bar{1} = \bar{0} \rangle$. $\square$

- (16) Show that the group $\langle x_1, y_1 \mid x_1^2 = y_1^2 = (x_1 y_1)^2 = 1 \rangle$ is the dihedral group D_4 (where x_1 may be replaced by the letter r and y_1 by s). (Show that the last relation is the same as $x_1 y_1 = y_1 x_1^{-1}$.)

Solution. Note that $D_4 = \langle r, s \mid r^2 = s^2 = 1, rs = sr^{-1} \rangle$. Note that $r = r^{-1}$ so that $rs = sr$. Put $x_1 = r$ and $y_1 = s$. If $rs = sr$, then $(x_1 y_1)^2 = r s r s = r^2 s^2 = 1$. Moreover, if $(x_1 y_1)^2 = 1$, then $r s r s = 1$ so that $rs = sr$. $\square$

- (17) Let X_{2n} be the group whose presentation is displayed in (1.2).

- Show that if $n = 3k$, then X_{2n} has order 6, and it has the same generators and relations as D_6 when x is replaced by r and y by s .
- Show that if $(3, n) = 1$, then x satisfies the additional relation: $x = 1$. In this case deduce that X_{2n} has order 2. [use the facts that $x^n = 1$ and $x^3 = 1$.]

Solution.

- Applying $n = 3k$, we have $X_{2n} = X_{6k} = \langle x, y \mid x^{3k} = y^2 = 1, xy = yx^2 \rangle$. Now suppose the given relations, and recall the text showing $x^3 = 1$. Set $x = r$ and $y = s$. Then $r^3 = 1$ and $s^2 = 1$. From $xy = yx^2$, we have $rs = sr^2 = sr^{-1}$.

Suppose now that $r^3 = s^2 = 1$ and $rs = sr^{-1}$. Then $x^{3k} = (x^3)^k = 1$. Moreover, $s^2 = y^2 = 1$, and $xy = rs = sr^{-1} = sr^2 = yx^2$. Then the two representations are equal.

- Note that $(3, n) = 1$ implies that $3a + nb = 1$ for some $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $x = x^{3a+nb} = x^{3a} x^{nb} = (x^3)^a (x^n)^b = 1$. Then $X_{2n} = \{1, y\}$, and $|X_{2n}| = 2$. $\square$

- (18) Let Y be the group whose presentation is displayed in (1.3).

- Show that $v^2 = v^{-1}$. [Use the relation $v^3 = 1$.]
- Show that v commutes with u^3 . [Show that $v^2 u^3 v = u^3$ by writing the left-hand side as $(v^2 u^2)(uv)$ and using the relations to reduce this to the right-hand side. Then use part (a).]
- Show that v commutes with u . [Show that $u^9 = u$ and then use part (b).]
- Show that $uv = 1$. [Use part (c) and the last relation.]
- Show that $u = 1$. Deduce that $v = 1$, and conclude that $Y = 1$. [Use part (d) and the equation $u^4 v^3 = 1$.]

Solution.

- (a) $v^3 = 1 \implies v^2 = v^{-1}$.
 (b) From $uv = v^2u^2$, we have $vuv = u^2$ so that $vu = u^2v^{-1} = u^2v^2$. It follows that $v^2u^3v = (v^2u^2)(uv) = (uv)(uv) = u(vu)v = u(u^2v^2)v = u^3$.
 (c) It follows that $u^9 = (u^4)^2u = u$. Then $uv = (u^3)^3v = v(u^3)^3 = vu$.
 (d) $uv = v^2u^2 = u^2v^2$. Then $1 = uv$.
 (e) $u^4v^3 = u(uv)^3 = u1^3 = 1$. Then $1v = 1$, and $u = v = 1$, so $Y = 1$. □

1.3 Symmetric Groups

- (1) Let σ be the permutation

$$1 \mapsto 3, \quad 2 \mapsto 4, \quad 3 \mapsto 5, \quad 4 \mapsto 2, \quad 5 \mapsto 1$$

and let τ be the permutation

$$1 \mapsto 5, \quad 2 \mapsto 3, \quad 3 \mapsto 2, \quad 4 \mapsto 4, \quad 5 \mapsto 1.$$

Find the cycle decompositions of each of the following permutations: $\sigma, \tau, \sigma^2, \sigma\tau, \tau\sigma$, and $\tau^2\sigma$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma &= (1\ 3\ 5)(2\ 4) \\ \tau &= (1\ 5)(2\ 3) \\ \sigma^2 &= (1\ 5\ 3) \\ \sigma\tau &= (2\ 5\ 3\ 4) \\ \tau\sigma &= (1\ 2\ 4\ 3) \\ \tau^2\sigma &= (1\ 3\ 5)(2\ 4)\end{aligned}$$

□

- (2) Let σ be the permutation

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} 1 \mapsto 13 & 2 \mapsto 2 & 3 \mapsto 15 & 4 \mapsto 14 & 5 \mapsto 10 \\ 6 \mapsto 7 & 7 \mapsto 12 & 8 \mapsto 9 & 9 \mapsto 3 & 10 \mapsto 1 \\ 11 \mapsto 7 & 12 \mapsto 9 & 13 \mapsto 5 & 14 \mapsto 11 & 15 \mapsto 8 \end{array}$$

and let τ be the permutation

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} 1 \mapsto 14 & 2 \mapsto 9 & 3 \mapsto 10 & 4 \mapsto 2 & 5 \mapsto 12 \\ 6 \mapsto 6 & 7 \mapsto 5 & 8 \mapsto 11 & 9 \mapsto 15 & 10 \mapsto 3 \\ 11 \mapsto 8 & 12 \mapsto 7 & 13 \mapsto 4 & 14 \mapsto 1 & 15 \mapsto 13 \end{array}$$

Find the cycle decompositions of the following permutations: $\sigma, \tau, \sigma^2, \sigma\tau, \tau\sigma$, and $\tau^2\sigma$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma &= (1\ 13\ 5\ 1)(3\ 15\ 8)(4\ 14\ 11\ 7\ 12\ 9) \\ \tau &= (1\ 14)(2\ 9\ 15\ 13\ 4)(3\ 10)(5\ 12\ 7)(8\ 11) \\ \sigma^2 &= (1\ 5)(3\ 8\ 15)(4\ 11\ 12)(7\ 9\ 14)(10\ 13) \\ \sigma\tau &= (1\ 11\ 3)(2\ 4)(5\ 9\ 8\ 7\ 10\ 15)(8\ 10\ 14) \\ \tau\sigma &= (1\ 4)(2\ 9)(3\ 13\ 12\ 15\ 11\ 5)(8\ 10\ 14) \\ \tau^2\sigma &= (1\ 2\ 15\ 8\ 3\ 4\ 14\ 11\ 12\ 13\ 7\ 5\ 10)\end{aligned}$$

□

- (3) For each of the permutations whose cycle decompositions were computed in the preceding two exercises, compute its order.

Solution. Note that the order of a cycle decomposition is the lcm of the orders of each of the cycles, and that the order of an m -cycle is m . Then the orders are the following (the first number will be for Exercise 1, and the second for Exercise 2):

$$\begin{aligned} |\sigma| &= 6, 12 \\ |\tau| &= 2, 30 \\ |\sigma^2| &= 3, 6 \\ |\sigma\tau| &= 4, 6 \\ |\tau\sigma| &= 4, 6 \\ |\tau^2\sigma| &= 6, 13 \end{aligned}$$

□

(4) Compute the order of each of the elements in the following groups:

- (a) S_3
(b) S_4

Solution.

(a)

Permutation	Order
1	1
(12)	2
(13)	2
(23)	2
(123)	3
(132)	3

(b)

Permutation	Order	Permutation	Order	Permutation	Order	Permutation	Order
1	1	(34)	2	(143)	3	(1342)	4
(12)	2	(123)	3	(234)	3	(1423)	4
(13)	2	(124)	3	(243)	3	(1432)	4
(14)	2	(132)	3	(1234)	4	(12)(34)	2
(23)	2	(134)	3	(1243)	4	(13)(24)	2
(24)	2	(142)	3	(1324)	4	(14)(23)	2

□

(5) Find the order of $(1\ 12\ 8\ 10\ 4)(2\ 13)(5\ 11\ 7)(6\ 9)$.

Solution. $\text{lcm}(5, 2, 3) = 30$.

□

(6) Write out the cycle decomposition of each element of order 4 in S_4 .

Solution. See Exercise 4.

□

(7) Write out the cycle decomposition of each element of order 2 in S_4 .

Solution. See Exercise 4.

□

(8) Prove that if $\Omega = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$, then S_Ω is an infinite group (do not say $\infty! = \infty$).

Solution. Consider the permutation $\sigma_n = (2n-1\ 2n)$. Note that $\sigma_i \neq \sigma_j$ for any $i, j \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ so that the set $A = \{\sigma_n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$ are all distinct. Moreover, A is an infinite subset of S_Ω so that $|S_\Omega| = \infty$.

□

- (9) (a) Let σ be the 12-cycle $(1\ 2\ 3\ 4\ 5\ 6\ 7\ 8\ 9\ 10\ 11\ 12)$. For which positive integers i is σ^i also a 12-cycle?
(b) Let τ be the 8-cycle $(1\ 2\ 3\ 4\ 5\ 6\ 7\ 8)$. For which positive integers i is τ^i also an 8-cycle?

(c) Let ω be the 14-cycle $(1\ 2\ 3\ 4\ 5\ 6\ 7\ 8\ 9\ 10\ 11\ 12\ 13\ 14)$. For which positive integers i is ω^i also a 14-cycle?

Solution.

(a) We will compute the explicit powers for the first problem, notice a pattern with the integers that produce a 12-cycle, and apply that pattern to the other problems.

For each integer between 1 and 11, we compute the cycle:

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma^1 &= \sigma \\ \sigma^2 &= (1\ 3\ 5\ 7\ 9\ 11)(2\ 4\ 6\ 8\ 10\ 12) \\ \sigma^3 &= (1\ 4\ 7\ 10)(2\ 5\ 8\ 11)(3\ 6\ 9\ 12) \\ \sigma^4 &= (1\ 5\ 9)(2\ 6\ 10)(3\ 7\ 11)(4\ 8\ 12) \\ \sigma^5 &= \sigma \\ \sigma^6 &= (1\ 7)(2\ 8)(3\ 9)(4\ 10)(5\ 11)(6\ 12) \\ \sigma^7 &= \sigma \\ \sigma^8 &= \sigma^4 \\ \sigma^9 &= \sigma^3 \\ \sigma^{10} &= \sigma^2 \\ \sigma^{11} &= \sigma\end{aligned}$$

From direct calculations, it seems that the integers i such that $(12, i) = 1$ produce a 12-cycle, while i such that $(12, i) = k$ produces k 12/ k -cycles. In this particular case, the set of integers that produce a 12-cycle is the set $\{x + 12k \mid x \in \{1, 5, 7, 11\}, k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$.

(b) $\{x + 8k \mid x \in \{1, 3, 5, 7\}, k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$.

(c) $\{x + 14k \mid x \in \{1, 3, 5, 9, 11, 13\}, k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. □

(10) Prove that if σ is the m -cycle $(a_1\ a_2\ \dots\ a_m)$, then for all $i \in \{1, 2, \dots, m\}$, $\sigma^i(a_k) = a_{k+i}$, where $k+i$ is replaced by its least residue mod m when $k+i > m$. Deduce that $|\sigma| = m$.

Solution. We prove the first part by induction. Clearly for $i = 1$, this holds true by definition of cycles. Suppose it holds true for some $i \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $\sigma^{i+1}(a_k) = \sigma(\sigma^i(a_k)) = \sigma(a_{k+i}) = a_{k+i+1}$.

Now suppose $1 \leq i < m$. Then $\sigma^i(a_1) = a_{1+i} \neq a_1$. But then $\sigma^m(a_1) = a_{1+m} = a_1$ since $(1+m) \bmod m = 1$. Then $|\sigma| = m$. □

(11) Let σ be the m -cycle $(1\ 2\ \dots\ m)$. Show that σ^i is also an m -cycle if and only if i is relatively prime to m .

Solution. Suppose σ^i is an m -cycle, and put $(m, i) = d$. Then there exists $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ such that $ad = i$ and $bd = m$. Noting that $|\sigma^i| = m$ because it is an m -cycle, then $(\sigma^i)^b = (\sigma^{ad})^b = (\sigma^{bd})^a = (\sigma^m)^a = 1^a = 1$. Then $|\sigma^i| \leq b$, or $m = b$. It follows that $d = 1$.

Suppose that $(m, i) = 1$, and denote $x' \equiv x \bmod m$. Note that the integers $(1+i)', (1+2i)', \dots, (1+(m-1)i)'$ are all distinct, since for any $0 \leq x, y \leq m-1$ such that $x \neq y$, then $xi \equiv yi \bmod m$ implies $x = y$ (This is seen as follows: $i(x-y) \equiv 0 \bmod m$ implies that $m \mid (x-y)$, since $(m, i) = 1$. Since $1-m \leq x-y \leq m-1$, then the only choice for $x-y$ is 0, or that $x = y$). Then we have m integers so that

$$\sigma^i = (1\ (1+i)'\ (1+2i)'\ \dots\ (1+(m-1)i)'),$$

and σ^i is an m -cycle. □

(12) (a) If $\tau = (1\ 2)(3\ 4)(5\ 6)(7\ 8)(9\ 10)$, determine whether there is an n -cycle ($n \geq 10$) with $\tau = \sigma^k$ for some integer k .

(b) If $\tau = (1\ 2)(3\ 4\ 5)$, determine whether there is an n -cycle ($n \geq 5$) with $\tau = \sigma^k$ for some integer k .

Solution.

(a) $\sigma = (1\ 3\ 5\ 7\ 9\ 2\ 4\ 6\ 8\ 10), \sigma^5 = \tau$.

(b) We first prove that $(ac, bc) = c(a, b)$. Let $d = (a, b)$ and $d' = (ac, bc)$. Then there exist $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ax + by = d$. Then $acx + bcy = dc$. Since d' is the smallest integer that is written of the form $acx' + bcy'$ for $x', y' \in \mathbb{Z}$ (if there were any greater, then $d' \neq (ac, bc)$), then $d' \leq dc$. Moreover, $d \mid a$ and $d \mid b$ implies $cd \mid ac$ and $cd \mid bc$. Then $cd \mid d'$, or $cd \leq d'$. Then $dc = d'$, or $c(a, b) = (ac, bc)$.

Suppose there existed some n -cycle σ and k such that $\sigma^k = \tau$. Then $\sigma^{2k}(1) = 1$, or $2k \equiv 0 \pmod n$. Moreover, $\sigma^{3k}(3) = 3$, or that $3k \equiv 0 \pmod n$. Then $n \mid 2k$ and $n \mid 3k$ so that $n \mid (2k, 3k)$. By the above, then $(2k, 3k) = k(2, 3) = k$, and $n \mid k$. But then $\sigma^k = (\sigma^n)^q = 1$, contradicting that $\sigma^k = \tau$. $\square$

- (13) Show that an element has order 2 in S_n if and only if its cycle decomposition is a product of commuting 2-cycles.

Solution. Suppose $\sigma \in S_n$ such that $|\sigma| = 2$. Perform cycle decomposition on σ so that it becomes a product of commuting, disjoint cycles. Pick one of the cycles $(a_1 a_2 \dots a_m)$. Since $\sigma \neq 1$, then $\sigma(a_1) = a_2$ and $\sigma^2(a_1) = a_3$. However, $\sigma^2 = 1$, so $\sigma^2(a_1) = a_1$ so that $a_1 = a_3$. Then $m \leq 2$, and the cycle is $(a_1 a_2)$ so that any cycle in the cycle decomposition of σ is of length 2.

Suppose $\sigma = (a_1 b_1)(a_2 b_2) \dots (a_k b_k)$. Since $(a_1 b_1)^2 = 1$, and the 2-cycles commute, then $\sigma^2 = 1$. Moreover, because $\sigma \neq 1$, then $|\sigma| = 2$. $\square$

- (14) Let p be a prime. Show that an element has order p in S_n if and only if its cycle decomposition is a product of commuting p -cycles. Show by an explicit example that this need not be the case if p is not prime.

Solution. Suppose $\sigma \in S_n$ such that $|\sigma| = p$ that is prime. Put

$$\sigma = \pi_1 \pi_2 \dots \pi_k$$

as the cycle decomposition of σ so that π_i commutes with π_j for any $i \neq j$. Clearly, $\sigma^p = \pi_1^p \pi_2^p \dots \pi_k^p$. Since $\sigma^p = 1$, then each $\pi_i^p = 1$. Then π_i must be a p -cycle or $\pi_i = 1$. But no $\pi_i = 1$, since $\sigma \neq 1$. Then π_i must be a p -cycle.

Suppose σ 's cycle decomposition is a product of commuting p -cycles π_i . Then for any $t < p$, we have

$$\sigma^t = \pi_1^t \pi_2^t \dots \pi_k^t \neq 1$$

since π_i is a p -cycle. If $t = p$, then $\sigma^t = 1$. Then $|\sigma| = p$. $\square$

- (15) Prove that the order of an element in S_n equals the least common multiple of the lengths of the cycles in its cycle decomposition.

Solution. Let $\sigma \in S_n$ have the cycle decomposition $\sigma = \pi_1 \pi_2 \dots \pi_k$, and let π_i have length p_i so that $|\pi_i| = p_i$. Suppose $|\sigma| = m$. Then $\pi_i^m = 1$ so that $p_i \mid m$. In particular, every p_i must divide m so that m is a common multiple of all p_i . Moreover, if there was another t such that $\sigma^t = 1$, then t must be a common multiple of all p_i and $m \leq t$ so that m is the least common multiple of all p_i . $\square$

- (16) Show that if $n \geq m$ then the number of m -cycles in S_n is given by

$$\frac{n(n-1)(n-2) \dots (n-m+1)}{m}.$$

[Count the number of ways of forming an m -cycle and divide by the number of representations of a particular m -cycle.]

Solution. Note that in an m -cycle, there are m integers to write. The first integer has n choices, the second $n-1$ choices. Continuing on, then the m -th integer has $n-m+1$ choices. However, each choice of m integers has m equivalent representations (such as $(1\ 2\ 3\ 4)$ being equivalent to $(2\ 3\ 4\ 1)$ by shifting each integer to the left one place). Then take the product $n(n-1)(n-2) \dots (n-m+1)$ and divide by m . $\square$

- (17) Show that if $n \geq 4$ then the number of permutations in S_n which are the product of two disjoint 2-cycles is $n(n-1)(n-2)(n-3)/8$.

Solution. The first 2-cycle has $n(n-1)/2$ choices, and the second 2-cycle has $(n-2)(n-3)/2$ choices. Moreover, there are 2 representations for the same set of 2-cycles, so multiply the above quantities and divide by 2 to obtain $n(n-1)(n-2)(n-3)/8$. $\square$

- (18) Find all numbers n such that S_5 contains an element of order n .

Solution. S_5 contains elements of order 1 through 5. Moreover, we can have a 2 and 3-cycle together whose lcm is 6. Then $n = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6$. $\square$

- (19) Find all numbers n such that S_7 contains a number an element of order n .

Solution. We have n from 1 to 7. We can have 2 and 5-cycles and 3 and 4-cycles. Then $n = 10$ and 12. $\square$

- (20) Find a set of generators and relations for S_3 .

Solution. Recall that $S_3 = \{1, (1\ 2), (1\ 3), (2\ 3), (1\ 2\ 3), (1\ 3\ 2)\}$. Moreover, no element in S_3 has order 6 so that no element generates S_3 . It must be that there are at least 2 generators. Put $\alpha = (1\ 2)$ and $\beta = (1\ 3)$. Then $\alpha^2 = \beta^2 = 1$. Then $|\alpha| = |\beta| = 2$, and $\alpha\beta = (1\ 3\ 2)$, $\beta\alpha = (1\ 2\ 3)$, and $\alpha\beta\alpha = (2\ 3)$. Since $\alpha^2 = \beta^2 = 1$ is not enough to determine the order of $\alpha\beta$ (because $\alpha\beta \neq \beta\alpha$), then we must add $(\alpha\beta)^2 = 1$. Then we have the presentation $S_3 = \langle \alpha, \beta \mid \alpha^2 = \beta^2 = (\alpha\beta)^3 = 1 \rangle$. $\square$

1.4 Matrix Groups

Let F be a field and let $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$.

- (1) Prove that $|\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_2)| = 6$.

Solution. Note that $\mathbb{F}_2 = \{0, 1\}$. Moreover, consider

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$$

The determinant is $ad - bc$, which is never 0 whenever a, d are nonzero or when b, c are nonzero, but not both. Then

$$\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_2) = \left(\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \right)$$

$\square$

- (2) Write out all the elements of $\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$ and compute the order of each element.

Solution. By direct calculation, we obtain the following:

A	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$ A $	1	2	2	2	3	3

$\square$

- (3) Show that $\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$ is non-abelian.

Solution.

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$\square$

- (4) Show that if n is not prime then $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is not a field.

Solution. Since n is not prime, there exists $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ such that $n = ab$. Since $(a, n) \neq 1$, then Section 0, Proposition 4 says that a has no multiplicative inverse. $\square$

- (5) Show that $\mathrm{GL}_n(F)$ is a finite group if and only if F has a finite number of elements.

Solution. Suppose F is infinite. Note that the set $\{\alpha I \mid \alpha \in F^\times\} \subseteq \mathrm{GL}_n(F)$. Then $\mathrm{GL}_n(F)$ is infinite.

Suppose $|F| = m < \infty$. Then there are m^{n^2} potential $n \times n$ matrices, and less whose determinants are nonzero. Then $|\mathrm{GL}_n(F)|$ is finite. $\square$

- (6) If $|F| = q$ is finite prove that $|\mathrm{GL}_n(F)| < q^{n^2}$.

Solution. See previous solution. □

- (7) Let p be a prime. Prove that the order of $\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is $p^4 - p^3 - p^2 + p$ (do not just quote the order formula in this section). [Subtract the number of 2×2 matrices which are *not* invertible from the total number of 2×2 matrices over $\mathbb{F}_p$. You may use the fact that a 2×2 matrix is not invertible if and only if one row is a multiple of the other.]

Solution. Note that the number of 2×2 matrices with entries from $\mathbb{F}_p$ is p^4 . Using the given fact, let r_1 denote the first row and r_2 the second row of the matrices. Then if $r_1 = k r_2$ for some $k \in \mathbb{F}_p$, then the matrix is linearly independent. We then cover the cases:

1. Suppose $r_1 = 0$. Then r_2 is automatically a multiple of r_1 , and there are p^2 choices for r_2 since there are 2 entries.
2. Suppose $r_1 \neq 0$. Then we have $p^2 - 1$ choices for r_1 . Since there are p scalars, then we have p choices for r_2 (take $k r_1$ for $k \in \{0, 1, \dots, p-1\}$). Then there are $(p^2 - 1)p = p^3 - p$ matrices that are not invertible. The total of matrices that are not invertible is then $p^3 + p^2 - p$. The result follows. □

- (8) Show that $\mathrm{GL}_n(F)$ is non-abelian for any $n \geq 2$ and any F .

Solution. Note that every F has elements 0 and 1 as additive and multiplicative identities respectively, so we may safely assume $\mathbb{F}_2$ to be our field.

Proceeding by induction, the case of $n = 2$ was proven in Exercise 3. Now suppose $\mathrm{GL}_{n-1}(\mathbb{F}_2)$ is non-abelian for $n \geq 3$. Let $A, B \in \mathrm{GL}_{n-1}(\mathbb{F}_2)$ be noncommuting matrices. Using a block matrix, then

$$\begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} B & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} AB & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \neq \begin{pmatrix} BA & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} B & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

□

- (9) Prove that the binary operation of matrix multiplication of 2×2 matrices with real number entries is associative.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a' & b' \\ c' & d' \end{pmatrix} \right] \begin{pmatrix} a'' & b'' \\ c'' & d'' \end{pmatrix} &= \begin{pmatrix} aa' + bc' & ab' + bd' \\ ca' + dc' & cb' + dd' \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a'' & b'' \\ c'' & d'' \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} (aa' + bc')a'' + (ab' + bd')c'' & (aa' + bc')b'' + (ab' + bd')d'' \\ (ca' + dc')a'' + (cb' + dd')c'' & (ca' + dc')b'' + (cb' + dd')d'' \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} aa'a'' + bca'' + ab'c'' + bd'c'' & aa'b'' + bc'b'' + ab'd'' + bd'd'' \\ ca'a'' + dc'a'' + cb'c'' + dd'c'' & ca'b'' + dc'b'' + cb'd'' + dd'd'' \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a(a'a'' + b'c'') + b(c'a'' + d'c'') & a(a'b'' + b'd'') + b(c'b'' + d'd'') \\ c(a'a'' + b'c'') + d(c'a'' + d'c'') & c(a'b'' + b'd'') + d(c'b'' + d'd'') \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a'a'' + b'c'' & a'b'' + b'd'' \\ c'a'' + d'c'' & c'b'' + d'd'' \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \left[\begin{pmatrix} a' & b' \\ c' & d' \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a'' & b'' \\ c'' & d'' \end{pmatrix} \right] \end{aligned}$$

□

- (10) Let

$$G = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & c \end{pmatrix} \mid a, b, c \in \mathbb{R}, a \neq 0, c \neq 0 \right\}$$

- (a) Compute the product of $\begin{pmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ 0 & c_1 \end{pmatrix}$ and $\begin{pmatrix} a_2 & b_2 \\ 0 & c_2 \end{pmatrix}$ to show that G is closed under matrix multiplication.

- (b) Find the matrix inverse of $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & c \end{pmatrix}$ and deduce that G is closed under inverses.
- (c) Deduce that G is a subgroup of $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ (cf. Exercise 26, Section 1).
- (d) Prove that the set of elements of G whose two diagonal entries are equal (i.e., $a = c$) is also a subgroup of $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$.

Solution.

(a)

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ 0 & c_1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a_2 & b_2 \\ 0 & c_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 a_2 & a_1 b_2 + b_1 c_2 \\ 0 & c_1 c_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Since $a_i \neq 0$ and $c_i \neq 0$, then $a_1 a_2 \neq 0$ and $c_1 c_2 \neq 0$ so that G is closed under matrix multiplication.

(b) The determinant is ac . We then have the inverse

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & c \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ac} \begin{pmatrix} c & -b \\ 0 & a \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1/a & -b/ac \\ 0 & 1/c \end{pmatrix}$$

(c) Since G is closed under inverses and matrix multiplication, the result follows.

(d) Let $H = \{A \in G \mid a = c\}$. Then

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ 0 & a_1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a_2 & b_2 \\ 0 & a_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 a_2 & a_1 b_2 + b_1 a_2 \\ 0 & a_1 a_2 \end{pmatrix} \in H$$

and

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & a \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{a^2} \begin{pmatrix} a & -b \\ 0 & a \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1/a & -b/a^2 \\ 0 & 1/a \end{pmatrix} \in H$$

Then H is closed under inverses and matrix multiplication, hence it is a subgroup of $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$. $\square$

(11) Let

$$H(F) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \mid a, b, c \in F \right\}$$

called the *Heisenberg group* over F . Let

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ and } Y = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d & e \\ 0 & 1 & f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

be elements of $H(F)$.

- (a) Compute the matrix product XY and deduce that $H(F)$ is closed under matrix multiplication. Exhibit explicit matrices such that $XY \neq YX$ (so that $H(F)$ is always non-abelian).
- (b) Find an explicit formula for the matrix inverse X^{-1} and deduce that $H(F)$ is closed under inverses.
- (c) Prove the associative law for $H(F)$ and deduce that $H(F)$ is a group of order $|F|^3$. (Do not assume that matrix multiplication is associative.)
- (d) Find the order of each element of the finite group $H(\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})$.
- (e) Prove that every nonidentity of the group $H(\mathbb{R})$ has infinite order.

Solution.

(a) The product is calculated:

$$XY = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d+a & e+af+b \\ 0 & 1 & f+c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in H(F)$$

Moreover, we have that

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \neq \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

(b) To calculate the inverse, one can use Gaussian elimination:

$$\left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & a & b & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & c & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right) \Rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -a & ac-b \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right)$$

The right 3×3 matrix, call it Z , is the inverse of X and can be shown as such through direct calculation, i.e., $XZ = ZX = I$ so that $X^{-1} = Z$.

(c)

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d & e \\ 0 & 1 & f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \right] \begin{pmatrix} 1 & g & h \\ 0 & 1 & i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a+d & af+b+e \\ 0 & 1 & c+f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & g & h \\ 0 & 1 & i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a+d+g & h+i(a+d)+af+b+e \\ 0 & 1 & c+f+i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a+d+g & ai+ad+af+b+e+h \\ 0 & 1 & c+f+i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d+g & di+e+h \\ 0 & 1 & f+i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \left[\begin{pmatrix} 1 & d & e \\ 0 & 1 & f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & g & h \\ 0 & 1 & i \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \right] \end{aligned}$$

Moreover, there are 3 choices to vary in each matrix in $H(F)$, such as a, b, c in X . Then there are $|F|^3$ elements in $H(F)$.

(d) To save time, denote a matrix in $H(\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})$ as the 3-tuple (a, b, c) , where regular matrix multiplication is $(a, b, c)(d, e, f) = (a+d, af+b+e, c+f)$. Note that $(a, b, c)^2 = (2a, ac+2b, 2c)$. Since $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, this degrades to $(0, ac, 0)$. We then have two cases to consider:

1. Suppose $ac = 0$. Then at least one of a and c is 0, while b can be 0 or 1. Then the matrices are $(0, 0, 0), (1, 0, 0), (0, 0, 1), (0, 1, 0), (1, 1, 0), (0, 1, 1)$. Except for $(0, 0, 0)$ which is the identity matrix and thus has order 2, squaring the other matrices results in $(0, 0, 0)$ so that each have order 2.
2. Suppose $ac = 1$. Then this occurs when both $a = c = 1$ and b is either 0 or 1. These are the matrices $(1, 1, 0)$ and $(1, 1, 1)$. Since squaring these matrices results in $(0, 0, 1)$ which has order 2. then the aforementioned matrices have order 4.

(e) Utilizing the same formulation as in part (d), let $A = (a, b, c) \in H(\mathbb{R})$. We prove that

$$(a, b, c)^n = (na, n(n-1)ac/2 + nb, nc)$$

To that end, it is clear that $n = 1$ holds true. Suppose it holds for some n . Then for $n + 1$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} (a, b, c)^{n+1} &= (a, b, c)^n (a, b, c) \\ &= (na, n(n-1)ac/2 + nb, nc)(a, b, c) \\ &= (na+a, (na)c + n(n-1)ac/2 + nb+b, nc+c) \\ &= ((n+1)a, n(n+1)ac/2 + (n+1)b, (n+1)c) \end{aligned}$$

so that the relationship is true by induction. Since $A \neq I$, then at least one of a, b, c must be nonzero. Then for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, none of the integers $na, n(n-1)ac/2 + nb$, or nc are 0. Then no power of (a, b, c) results in $(0, 0, 0)$, hence no nonidentity element of $H(\mathbb{R})$ has any finite order. Therefore, every nonidentity element of $H(\mathbb{R})$ has infinite order. $\square$

1.5 The Quaternion Group

- (1) Compute the order of each of the elements in Q_8 .

Solution.

a	1	-1	i	$-i$	j	$-j$	k	$-k$
$ a $	1	2	4	4	4	4	4	4

$\square$

- (2) Write out the group tables for S_3, D_8 , and Q_8 .

Solution. S_3 :

$\circ$	1	(1 2)	(1 3)	(2 3)	(1 2 3)	(1 3 2)
1	1	(1 2)	(1 3)	(2 3)	(1 2 3)	(1 3 2)
(1 2)	(1 2)	1	(1 2 3)	(1 3 2)	(1 3)	(2 3)
(1 3)	(1 3)	(1 3 2)	1	(1 2 3)	(2 3)	(1 2)
(2 3)	(2 3)	(1 2 3)	(1 3 2)	1	(1 2)	(1 3)
(1 2 3)	(1 2 3)	(2 3)	(1 2)	(1 3)	(1 3 2)	1
(1 3 2)	(1 3 2)	(1 3)	(2 3)	(1 2)	1	(1 2 3)

D_8 :

$\circ$	1	r	r^2	r^3	s	sr	sr^2	sr^3
1	1	r	r^2	r^3	s	sr	sr^2	sr^3
r	r	r^2	r^3	1	sr^3	s	sr	sr^2
r^2	r^2	r^3	1	r	sr^2	sr^3	s	sr
r^3	r^3	1	r	r^2	sr	sr^2	sr^3	s
s	s	sr	sr^2	sr^3	1	r	r^2	r^3
sr	sr	sr^2	sr^3	s	r^3	1	r	r^2
sr^2	sr^2	sr^3	s	sr	r^2	r^3	1	r
sr^3	sr^3	s	sr	sr^2	r	r^2	r^3	1

Q_8 :

$\cdot$	1	-1	i	$-i$	j	$-j$	k	$-k$
1	1	-1	i	$-i$	j	$-j$	k	$-k$
-1	-1	1	$-i$	i	$-j$	j	$-k$	k
i	i	$-i$	1	1	k	$-k$	j	$-j$
$-i$	$-i$	i	1	-1	$-k$	k	$-j$	j
j	j	$-j$	$-k$	k	-1	1	i	$-i$
$-j$	$-j$	j	k	$-k$	1	-1	$-i$	i
k	k	$-k$	j	$-j$	$-i$	i	-1	1
$-k$	$-k$	k	$-j$	j	i	$-i$	1	-1

$\square$

- (3) Find a set of generators and relations for Q_8 .

Solution. An extra relation is necessary to intertwine i, j, k together, so a presentation for Q_8 is:

$$Q_8 = \langle -1, i, j, k \mid i^2 = j^2 = k^2 = ijk = -1 \rangle$$

$\square$

1.6 Homomorphisms and Isomorphisms

(1) Let $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ be a homomorphism.

(a) Prove that $\varphi(x^n) = \varphi(x)^n$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$.

(b) Do part (a) for $n = -1$ and deduce that $\varphi(x^n) = \varphi(x)^n$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Solution.

(a) It is clear for $n = 1$. Supposing it holds for some n , then for $n+1$, we have $\varphi(x^{n+1}) = \varphi(x^n x) = \varphi(x^n)\varphi(x) = \varphi(x)^n \varphi(x) = \varphi(x)^{n+1}$.

(b) We first prove that φ maps the identity of G to the identity of H . To that end, we have $\varphi(1_G) = \varphi(1_G 1_G) = \varphi(1_G)\varphi(1_G)$ (which is the case for $n = 0$). By cancellation, then $1_H = \varphi(1_G)$ so that identities map to each other. Now see that $1_H = \varphi(1_G) = \varphi(x x^{-1}) = \varphi(x)\varphi(x^{-1})$. Then $\varphi(x^{-1}) = \varphi(x)^{-1}$. Then for some $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, it follows that

$$\varphi(x^{-n}) = \varphi((x^{-1})^n) = \varphi(x^{-1})^n = (\varphi(x)^{-1})^n = \varphi(x)^{-n}$$

□

(2) If $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ is an isomorphism, prove that $|\varphi(x)| = |x|$ for all $x \in G$. Deduce that any two isomorphic groups have the same number of elements of order n for each $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Is the result true if φ is only assumed to be a homomorphism?

Solution. Let $|x| = m$ and $|\varphi(x)| = n$ for finite $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then

$$\varphi(x)^m = \varphi(x^m) = \varphi(1) = 1$$

so that $n \leq m$. Moreover,

$$\varphi(x^n) = \varphi(x)^n = 1$$

Since identities map to identities, then $x^n = 1$, or $m \leq n$. Then $m = n$. If m was infinite but n was not, then $\varphi(x^n) = \varphi(x)^n = 1$ implies that $x^n = 1$, contradicting that x had infinite order. Hence, both must have infinite order. Moreover, two isomorphic groups must have the same number of elements of some order because φ is a bijection, and $|x| = |\varphi(x)|$ for every $x \in G$.

The result is not true if φ is only a homomorphism. Take $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$, where H is the trivial group $\{1\}$, defined by $\varphi(x) = 1$. Since there are elements in G that would have orders of greater than 1 (except if G is also the trivial group), then φ does not preserve order. □

(3) If $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ is an isomorphism, prove that G is abelian if and only if H is abelian. If $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ is a homomorphism, what additional conditions on φ (if any) are sufficient to ensure that if G is abelian, then so is H ?

Solution. Note that φ^{-1} exists, since φ is bijective. It follows that both directions will be proved very similarly, so one direction is only shown: If G is abelian, then for any $h_1, h_2 \in H$, there exists $g_1, g_2 \in G$ such that $g_1 = \varphi^{-1}(h_1)$ and $g_2 = \varphi^{-1}(h_2)$. Then

$$h_1 h_2 = \varphi(g_1)\varphi(g_2) = \varphi(g_1 g_2) = \varphi(g_2 g_1) = \varphi(g_2)\varphi(g_1) = h_2 h_1$$

so that H is abelian. Moreover, the result does not always follow if φ is only a homomorphism. Consider the mapping $\varphi : (\mathbb{R}, +) \rightarrow \text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ defined by

$$\varphi(x) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Clearly, this is a homomorphism as

$$\varphi(x+y) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x+y \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & y \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \varphi(x)\varphi(y)$$

Note that upper triangular matrices commute with each other (so that $\varphi(\mathbb{R})$ is abelian), but in general $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ is not abelian. It follows that if φ is assumed only to be a homomorphism, then we must add the additional condition that φ is also surjective. Following the proof above, we may conclude that such g_1 and g_2 must exist because we may pick from the fibers of φ over h_1 and h_2 , i.e., $g_1 \in \varphi^{-1}(h_1)$ and $g_2 \in \varphi^{-1}(h_2)$ always exist since φ is surjective. □

- (4) Prove that the multiplicative groups $\mathbb{R} - \{0\}$ and $\mathbb{C} - \{0\}$ are not isomorphic.

Solution. $|i| = 4$ in $\mathbb{C} - \{0\}$, but there are no elements of order 4 in $\mathbb{R} - \{0\}$. □

- (5) Prove that the additive groups $\mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbb{Q}$ are not isomorphic.

Solution. $|\mathbb{R}| \neq |\mathbb{Q}|$. □

- (6) Prove that the additive groups $\mathbb{Z}$ and $\mathbb{Q}$ are not isomorphic.

Solution. Every nonidentity element in $\mathbb{Z}$ has infinite order, but elements of the form $1/r \in \mathbb{Q}$ where $r \in \mathbb{Z}$ has order r . □

- (7) Prove that D_8 and Q_8 are not isomorphic.

Solution. D_8 has only 1 element of order 4, while Q_8 has 3 elements of order 4. □

- (8) Prove that if $n \neq m$, then S_n and S_m are not isomorphic.

Solution. If $n \neq m$, then $n! \neq m!$ so that $|S_n| \neq |S_m|$. □

- (9) Prove that D_{24} and S_4 are not isomorphic.

Solution. D_{24} has elements of order 12 (e.g. r) but S_4 has no elements of order 12, since every element of S_4 is either a 2-cycle, 3-cycle, 4-cycle, or a combination of 2-cycles. □

- (10) Fill in the details of the proof that the symmetric groups S_Δ and S_Ω are isomorphic if $|\Delta| = |\Omega|$ as follows: let $\theta : \Delta \rightarrow \Omega$ be a bijection. Define

$$\varphi : S_\Delta \rightarrow S_\Omega \quad \text{by} \quad \varphi(\sigma) = \theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1} \quad \text{for all } \sigma \in S_\Delta$$

and prove the following:

- (a) Prove that φ is well-defined, that is, if σ is a permutation of Δ then $\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1}$ is a permutation of Ω .
- (b) Prove that φ is a bijection from S_Δ onto S_Ω by finding a two-sided inverse for φ .
- (c) Prove that φ is a homomorphism, that is, $\varphi(\sigma \circ \tau) = \varphi(\sigma) \circ \varphi(\tau)$.

Note the similarity to the change of basis or similarity transformations for matrices (we shall see the connections between these later in the text).

Solution.

- (a) Clearly $\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1}$ is a function from Ω to Ω . To show that it is a bijection, take some $a, b \in \Omega$ such that $\varphi(\sigma)(a) = \varphi(\sigma)(b)$, or $(\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1})(a) = (\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1})(b)$. Since θ is a bijection, then θ^{-1} is a bijection. Moreover, $\theta \in S_\Delta$ implies that it is a permutation of Δ so it too is a bijection. It then follows that $a = b$, or that $\varphi(\sigma)$ is an injection.

Now suppose $b \in \Omega$. Put $a = (\theta \circ \sigma^{-1} \circ \theta^{-1})(b)$. Then $\varphi(\sigma)(a) = b$ so that $\varphi(\sigma)$ is a surjection. Hence, it is a bijection and is a permutation of Ω .

- (b) Define $\psi : S_\Omega \rightarrow S_\Delta$ as

$$\psi(\pi) = \theta^{-1} \circ \pi \circ \theta \quad \text{for } \pi \in S_\Omega$$

Using similar reasoning in part (a), it is easy to see that ψ is a well-defined mapping. Moreover, for any $\sigma \in S_\Delta$, we have

$$(\psi \circ \varphi)(\sigma) = \psi(\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1}) = \theta^{-1} \circ (\theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1}) \circ \theta = \sigma$$

and for any $\pi \in S_\Omega$, we have

$$(\varphi \circ \psi)(\pi) = \varphi(\theta^{-1} \circ \pi \circ \theta) = \theta \circ (\theta^{-1} \circ \pi \circ \theta) \circ \theta^{-1} = \pi$$

Then ψ is a two-sided inverse of φ , hence $\psi = \varphi^{-1}$, and φ is indeed a bijection.

- (c) Pick $\sigma, \tau \in S_\Delta$. Then

$$\varphi(\sigma) \circ \varphi(\tau) = \theta \circ \sigma \circ \theta^{-1} \circ \theta \circ \tau \circ \theta^{-1} = \theta \circ \sigma \circ \tau \circ \theta^{-1} = \varphi(\sigma \circ \tau) \quad \square$$

- (11) Let A and B be groups. Prove that $A \times B \cong B \times A$.

Solution. Let $\varphi : A \times B \rightarrow B \times A$ be defined as $\varphi(a, b) = (b, a)$ for some $(a, b) \in A \times B$. Clearly, it is a homomorphism, since for $(a, b), (c, d) \in A \times B$, we have $\varphi((a, b)(c, d)) = \varphi(ac, bd) = (bd, ac) = (b, a)(d, c) = \varphi(a, b)\varphi(c, d)$. Moreover, for any $(b, a) \in B \times A$, then $\varphi(a, b) = (b, a)$ so that φ is surjective. Finally, suppose $\varphi(a, b) = \varphi(c, d)$ for $(a, b), (c, d) \in A \times B$. Then $(b, a) = (d, c)$, and comparing components results in $b = d$ and $a = c$, or $(a, b) = (c, d)$. Hence, φ is injective so that it is an isomorphism, and $A \times B \cong B \times A$. $\square$

- (12) Let A, B , and C be groups and let $G = A \times B$ and $H = B \times C$. Prove that $G \times C \cong A \times H$.

Solution. Let $\varphi : G \times C \rightarrow A \times H$ be defined as $\varphi((a, b), c) = (a, (b, c))$. This is easily checked to be an isomorphism. $\square$

- (13) Let G and H be groups and let $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ be a homomorphism. Prove that the image of φ , $\varphi(G)$, is a subgroup of H (cf. Exercise 26 of Section 1). Prove that if φ is injective then $G \cong \varphi(G)$.

Solution. Pick $\varphi(a), \varphi(b) \in \varphi(G)$. Note that $ab \in G$, since G is a group. Then $\varphi(a)\varphi(b) = \varphi(ab) \in \varphi(G)$ so that $\varphi(G)$ is closed under the operation of H . Moreover, $\varphi(a)^{-1} \in \varphi(G)$ since $\varphi(a)^{-1} = \varphi(a^{-1}) \in \varphi(G)$ because $a^{-1} \in G$. Then $\varphi(G)$ is a subgroup of H .

Suppose now that φ is injective, and define $\psi : G \rightarrow \varphi(G)$ as $\psi(g) = \varphi(g)$. Let $g, h \in G$. Then $\psi(gh) = \varphi(gh) = \varphi(g)\varphi(h) = \psi(g)\psi(h)$ so that ψ is a homomorphism. Moreover, if g, h are such that $\psi(g) = \psi(h)$, then $\varphi(g) = \varphi(h)$. Since φ is injective, then $g = h$ so that ψ is also injective. Moreover, for any $\varphi(g) \in \varphi(G)$, then $\psi(g) = \varphi(g)$ so that ψ is surjective. Hence, $G \cong \varphi(G)$. $\square$

- (14) Let G and H be groups and let $\varphi : G \rightarrow H$ be a homomorphism. Define the *kernel* of φ to be $\{g \in G \mid \varphi(g) = 1_H\}$ (so the kernel is the set of elements in G which map to the identity of H , i.e., is the fiber over the identity of H). Prove that the kernel of φ is a subgroup of G . Prove that φ is injective if and only if the kernel of φ is the identity subgroup of G .

Solution. For the remainder of this text, let $\ker(\varphi)$ denote the kernel of φ . Note that if $x, y \in \ker(\varphi)$, then $\varphi(xy) = \varphi(x)\varphi(y) = 1_H 1_H = 1_H$ so that $xy \in \ker(\varphi)$. Moreover, for some $x \in \ker(\varphi)$, then $\varphi(x^{-1}) = \varphi(x)^{-1} = 1_H^{-1} = 1_H$ so that $x^{-1} \in \ker(\varphi)$. Then $\ker(\varphi)$ is a subgroup of G .

Now suppose φ is injective, and pick $x \in \ker(\varphi)$. Then $\varphi(x) = 1_H$. However, $\varphi(1_G) = 1_H$ so that $\varphi(x) = \varphi(1_G)$. Then $x = 1_G$. If $\ker(\varphi)$ was instead trivial, suppose $\varphi(x) = \varphi(y)$ for some $x, y \in G$. In particular, then $\varphi(x)\varphi(y)^{-1} = 1_H$. Then $\varphi(x)\varphi(y^{-1}) = \varphi(xy^{-1}) = 1_H$. Since identities map to each other, then $xy^{-1} = 1_G$, or $x = y$. Then φ is injective. $\square$

- (15) Define a map $\pi : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by $\pi((x, y)) = x$. Prove that π is a homomorphism and find the kernel of π .

Solution. Let $(a, b), (c, d) \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Then

$$\pi((a, b) + (c, d)) = \pi(a + c, b + d) = a + c = \pi(a, b) + \pi(c, d)$$

so that π is a homomorphism. Moreover, if $\pi(a, b) = 0$, then $a = 0$ while b varies so that

$$\ker(\pi) = \{(0, b) \mid b \in \mathbb{R}\}$$

$\square$

- (16) Let A and B be groups and let G be their direct product, $A \times B$. Prove that the maps $\pi_1 : G \rightarrow A$ and $\pi_2 : G \rightarrow B$ defined by $\pi_1((a, b)) = a$ and $\pi_2((a, b)) = b$ are homomorphisms and find their kernels.

Solution. For $(a, b), (c, d) \in G$, then

$$\pi_1((a, b)(c, d)) = \pi_1(ac, bd) = ac = \pi_1(a, b)\pi_1(c, d)$$

and

$$\pi_2((a, b)(c, d)) = \pi_2(ac, bd) = bd = \pi_2(a, b)\pi_2(c, d)$$

Moreover, the kernels are

$$\ker(\pi_1) = \{(1, b) \mid b \in B\}$$

$$\ker(\pi_2) = \{(a, 1) \mid a \in A\}$$

$\square$

- (17) Let G be any group. Prove that the map from G to itself defined by $g \mapsto g^{-1}$ is a homomorphism if and only if G is abelian.

Solution. Let φ be the aforementioned mapping, and suppose φ is a homomorphism. Then for any $g, h \in G$, we have

$$(gh)^{-1} = \varphi(gh) = \varphi(g)\varphi(h) = g^{-1}h^{-1} = (hg)^{-1}$$

Since inverses are unique, then $gh = hg$, and G is abelian. If instead G was abelian, then

$$\varphi(gh) = (gh)^{-1} = h^{-1}g^{-1} = g^{-1}h^{-1} = \varphi(g)\varphi(h)$$

so that φ is a homomorphism. $\square$

- (18) Let G be any group. Prove that the map from G to itself defined by $g \mapsto g^2$ is a homomorphism if and only if G is abelian.

Solution. Let φ be the mapping, and suppose it is a homomorphism. Then for $g, h \in G$, we have

$$(gh)^2 = \varphi(gh) = \varphi(g)\varphi(h) = g^2h^2$$

Then $ghgh = gghh$. Left canceling the g and right canceling the h , we obtain $hg = gh$ so that G is abelian. If G is abelian, then

$$\varphi(gh) = (gh)^2 = g^2h^2 = \varphi(g)\varphi(h)$$

so that φ is a homomorphism. $\square$

- (19) Let $G = \{z \in \mathbb{C} \mid z^n = 1 \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$. Prove that for any fixed integer $k > 1$ the map from G to itself defined by $z \mapsto z^k$ is a surjective homomorphism but is not an isomorphism.

Solution. Recall the polar form of a complex number $z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) = re^{i\theta}$ for modulus r and argument θ . For every $z \in G$, then $r = 1$, so elements of G taken on the form $e^{i\theta}$. Moreover, because $z^n = 1$, then $e^{in\theta} = 1$. Lastly, the polar representation of 1 is given by $e^{i2\pi m}$ for some $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Equating the two exponents, or $in\theta = i2\pi m$, then $\theta = 2\pi m/n$, which means we can reformulate G as the following:

$$G = \{e^{i2\pi m/n} \in \mathbb{C} \mid m \in \mathbb{Z}, n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$$

To show that φ is a homomorphism, we may fall back to the original formulation of G : for any $z, w \in G$, then

$$\varphi(zw) = (zw)^k = z^k w^k = \varphi(z)\varphi(w)$$

Now suppose $w \in G$. Then $w = e^{i2\pi m/n}$. Since $z = e^{i2\pi m/nk} \in G$ because $nk \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, then $z^k = (e^{i2\pi m/nk})^k = e^{i2\pi m/n} = w$ so that $\varphi(z) = w$, and φ is surjective. Moreover, it is not an isomorphism because $\ker(\varphi)$ consists of the elements $z \in G$ such that $z^k = (e^{i2\pi m/n})^k = 1$. It follows that such z have a polar representation of $n = k$, or more explicitly:

$$\ker(\varphi) = \{e^{i2\pi m/k} \mid m = 0, 1, \dots, k-1\}$$

where m is cut off after $m = k-1$ since any two elements of $\ker(\varphi)$ are equivalent when they differ by a factor of 2π . $\square$

- (20) Let G be a group and let $\text{Aut}(G)$ be the set of all isomorphisms from G onto G . Prove that $\text{Aut}(G)$ is a group under function composition (called the *automorphism group* of G and the elements of $\text{Aut}(G)$ are called *automorphisms* of G).

Solution. Function composition is associative in general so that it is associative in $\text{Aut}(G)$. Since a composition of bijections is also a bijection, it suffices to check that a composition of homomorphisms is a homomorphism. In particular, let $\varphi, \psi \in \text{Aut}(G)$. Then for any $g, h \in G$, we have

$$(\varphi \circ \psi)(gh) = \varphi(\psi(gh)) = \varphi(\psi(g)\psi(h)) = \varphi(\psi(g))\varphi(\psi(h)) = (\varphi \circ \psi)(g)(\varphi \circ \psi)(h)$$

so that a composition of isomorphisms is also an isomorphism, and $\text{Aut}(G)$ is closed under function composition. The identity map $1 : G \rightarrow G$ is trivially in $\text{Aut}(G)$ so that it has identity. Lastly, for any $\varphi \in \text{Aut}(G)$, consider the bijective inverse φ^{-1} . Then for any $g, h \in G$, there are elements $a, b \in G$ such that $\varphi(a) = g$ and $\varphi(b) = h$. Then

$$\varphi^{-1}(gh) = \varphi^{-1}(\varphi(a)\varphi(b)) = \varphi^{-1}(\varphi(ab)) = ab = \varphi^{-1}(g)\varphi^{-1}(h)$$

so that $\text{Aut}(G)$ is closed under inverses. Then $\text{Aut}(G)$ is a group under function composition. $\square$

- (21) Prove that for each fixed nonzero $k \in \mathbb{Q}$ the map from $\mathbb{Q}$ to itself defined by $q \mapsto kq$ is an automorphism of $\mathbb{Q}$.

Solution. Suppose $\varphi(q) = \varphi(r)$ for $q, r \in \mathbb{Q}$. Then $kq = kr$, or $q = r$ so that φ is injective. Similarly, for any $q \in \mathbb{Q}$, then $\varphi(q/k) = k(q/k) = q$ so that φ is surjective. Lastly,

$$\varphi(q+r) = k(q+r) = kq + kr = \varphi(q) + \varphi(r)$$

and φ is a homomorphism. Then it is an automorphism of $\mathbb{Q}$. $\square$

- (22) Let A be an abelian group and fix some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Prove that the map $a \mapsto a^k$ is a homomorphism from A to itself. If $k = -1$ prove that this homomorphism is an isomorphism (i.e., is an automorphism of A).

Solution. Suppose $a, b \in A$. Then

$$\varphi(ab) = (ab)^k = a^k b^k = \varphi(a)\varphi(b)$$

so that it is a homomorphism of A . Moreover, if $k = -1$, refer to Exercise 17. $\square$

- (23) Let G be a finite group which possesses an automorphism σ such that $\sigma(g) = g$ if and only if $g = 1$. If σ^2 is the identity map from G to G , prove that G is abelian (such an automorphism σ is called *fixed point free* of order 2). [Show that every element of G can be written in the form $x^{-1}\sigma(x)$ and apply σ to such an expression.]

Solution. To show that every $g \in G$ is of the form $x^{-1}\sigma(x)$ for some $x \in G$, the natural choice is to show that $\varphi : G \rightarrow G$ defined by $\varphi(g) = g^{-1}\sigma(g)$ is a bijective function. To that end, suppose $g, h \in G$ such that $\varphi(g) = \varphi(h)$. Then $g^{-1}\sigma(g) = h^{-1}\sigma(h)$. Since $\sigma^2 = 1$, then $\sigma^{-1} = \sigma$, so that:

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi(g) = \varphi(h) &\implies g^{-1}\sigma(g) = h^{-1}\sigma(h) \\ &\implies \sigma(g) = gh^{-1}\sigma(h) \\ &\implies g = \sigma(gh^{-1}\sigma(h)) \\ &\implies g = \sigma(gh^{-1})h \\ &\implies gh^{-1} = \sigma(gh^{-1}) \end{aligned}$$

Then $gh^{-1} = 1$ because σ is fixed point free of order 2. It follows that $g = h$ so that φ is injective. Since G is finite, then φ is necessarily surjective so that φ is a bijection. From this, we conclude that each $g \in G$ can be associated with some $h^{-1}\sigma(h)$ for $h \in G$.

Now suppose $g \in G$. Then for some $x \in G$, we have $\sigma(g) = \sigma(x^{-1}\sigma(x)) = \sigma(x)^{-1}x = (x^{-1}\sigma(x))^{-1} = g^{-1}$. Then for any $h \in G$, we have

$$\sigma(gh) = (gh)^{-1} = h^{-1}g^{-1} = \sigma(h)\sigma(g) = \sigma(hg)$$

Since $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(G)$, then $gh = hg$. $\square$

- (24) Let G be a finite group and let x and y be distinct elements of order 2 in G that generate G . Prove that $G \cong D_{2n}$, where $n = |xy|$.

Solution. Put $t = xy$. Then $tx = xt^{-1}$, since $x = x^{-1}$ and $y = y^{-1}$. Moreover, $y = x^{-1}t = xt$ so that x and t generate G . Using the relation $tx = xt^{-1}$, then the elements of G may be written in the form $x^i t^j$ for $i \in \{0, 1\}$ and $0 \leq j < n-1$. Since $|t| = n$, then $x^i t^j$ is unique for any choice of i so that $\langle t \rangle$ has unique elements. It follows that $G = \{1, t, \dots, t^{n-1}, x, xt, \dots, xt^{n-1}\}$, and $|G| = 2n$.

Let $\varphi : D_{2n} \rightarrow G$ be given by

$$\varphi(s^i r^j) = x^i t^j, \quad \text{for } i, j \in \mathbb{Z} \text{ such that } i = \{0, 1\} \text{ and } 0 \leq j < n-1$$

It is known that every form of D_{2n} is unique by the representation above so that φ will be well-defined. Moreover, the elements $x, t \in G$ satisfy the relations of D_{2n} , i.e., $(xt)^n = x^2 = 1$, and $tx = xt^{-1}$. Then φ is a homomorphism. Lastly, suppose $x^i t^j \in G$. Then $\varphi(s^i r^j) = x^i t^j$ so that φ is surjective. Since G is finite, then φ is injective, and $G \cong D_{2n}$. $\square$

(25) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, let r and s be the usual generators of D_{2n} and let $\theta = 2\pi/n$.

(a) Prove that the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

is the matrix of the linear transformation which rotates the x, y -plane about the origin in a counter-clockwise direction by θ radians.

(b) Prove that the map $\varphi : D_{2n} \rightarrow \text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ defined on generators by

$$\varphi(r) = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \varphi(s) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

extends to a homomorphism of D_{2n} into $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$.

(c) Prove that the homomorphism φ defined above is injective.

Solution.

(a) Take any $\vec{v} = (x \ y)^T \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Then

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} x \cos \theta - y \sin \theta \\ x \sin \theta + y \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} = \vec{u}$$

Note that $|\vec{v}| = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$. The distance of this vector is

$$\begin{aligned} |\vec{u}| &= \sqrt{(x \cos \theta - y \sin \theta)^2 + (x \sin \theta + y \cos \theta)^2} \\ &= \sqrt{x^2 \cos^2 \theta - 2xy \cos \theta \sin \theta + y^2 \sin^2 \theta + x^2 \sin^2 \theta + 2xy \cos \theta \sin \theta + y^2 \cos^2 \theta} \\ &= \sqrt{x^2(\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta) + y^2(\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta)} \\ &= \sqrt{x^2 + y^2} \end{aligned}$$

so that $|\vec{u}| = |\vec{v}|$. Moreover, the angle θ' between $\vec{v}$ and $\vec{u}$ is

$$\begin{aligned} \cos(\theta') &= \frac{\vec{v} \cdot \vec{u}}{|\vec{v}||\vec{u}|} \\ &= \frac{x(x \cos \theta - y \sin \theta) + y(x \sin \theta + y \cos \theta)}{x^2 + y^2} \\ &= \frac{x^2 \cos \theta - xy \sin \theta + xy \sin \theta + y^2 \cos \theta}{x^2 + y^2} \\ &= \cos \theta \end{aligned}$$

so that $\theta' = \theta$. Then $\vec{u}$ is $\vec{v}$ rotated $\theta = 2\pi/n$ radians.

(b) We first show that

$$\varphi(r)^k = \begin{pmatrix} \cos(k\theta) & -\sin(k\theta) \\ \sin(k\theta) & \cos(k\theta) \end{pmatrix}$$

The case for $k = 1$ is clear. Supposing it holds true for some k , then for $k + 1$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}^{k+1} &= \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}^k \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} \cos(k\theta) & -\sin(k\theta) \\ \sin(k\theta) & \cos(k\theta) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} \cos(k\theta)\cos \theta - \sin(k\theta)\sin \theta & -\cos(k\theta)\sin \theta - \sin(k\theta)\cos \theta \\ \sin(k\theta)\cos \theta + \cos(k\theta)\sin \theta & -\sin(k\theta)\sin \theta + \cos(k\theta)\cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} \cos((k+1)\theta) & -\sin((k+1)\theta) \\ \sin((k+1)\theta) & \cos((k+1)\theta) \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

so the result follows by induction. From this, it is clear that $\varphi(r)^n = I$, since $\cos(2\pi) = 1$ and $\sin(2\pi) = 0$. Additionally, for $k = -1$, note that $\det(\varphi(r)) = 1$. Then

$$\varphi(r)^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -(-\sin \theta) \\ -\sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & \sin \theta \\ -\sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

Moreover, $\varphi(s)^2 = I$. Lastly,

$$\varphi(s)\varphi(r) = \begin{pmatrix} \sin \theta & \cos \theta \\ \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \end{pmatrix} = \varphi(r)^{-1}\varphi(s)$$

Since $\varphi(r)^n = \varphi(s)^2 = I$, and $\varphi(s)\varphi(r) = \varphi(r)^{-1}\varphi(s)$, i.e., the relations in D_{2n} hold in $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, then φ is a homomorphism.

(c) Suppose $\varphi(g) = I$. Then g can take on two forms:

- If $g = r^k$, then $\varphi(r)^k \neq I$ for any $k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1$, since $\theta = 2\pi k/n$.
- If $g = s r^k$, then $\varphi(s)\varphi(r)^k = I$, or $\varphi(s) = \varphi(r)^{-k}$. Note that $\det(\varphi(s)) = -1$, while $\det(\varphi(r)^k) = 1$. Since $\det(\varphi(s)) \neq \det(\varphi(r)^{-k})$, then $\varphi(s) \neq \varphi(r)^{-k}$ (this follows from $A = B \implies \det(A) = \det(B)$ for any $A, B \in \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$).

This shows that $\ker(\varphi) = 1$, so that φ is injective. $\square$

- (26) Let i and j be the generators of Q_8 described in Section 5. Prove that the map φ from Q_8 to $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ defined on generators by

$$\varphi(i) = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{-1} & 0 \\ 0 & -\sqrt{-1} \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \varphi(j) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

extends to a homomorphism. Prove that φ is injective.

Solution. It is easy to see that

$$\varphi(i)^2 = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{-1} & 0 \\ 0 & -\sqrt{-1} \end{pmatrix}^2 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix} = -I$$

and

$$\varphi(j)^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}^2 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix} = -I$$

Also note that

$$\varphi(i)\varphi(j) = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{-1} & 0 \\ 0 & -\sqrt{-1} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -\sqrt{-1} \\ -\sqrt{-1} & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

So we may set $\varphi(i)\varphi(j) = \varphi(k)$. We can calculate that $\varphi(k)^2 = -I$. It then follows that

$$\varphi(i)^2 = \varphi(j)^2 = \varphi(k)^2 = \varphi(i)\varphi(j)\varphi(k) = \varphi(-1)$$

Clearly these elements satisfy the same relations we found in Q_8 so that φ extends to a homomorphism from Q_8 to $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$. Moreover, it follows that $\varphi(x) = I$ only when $x = 1 \in Q_8$ as any nonidentity element in Q_8 does not map to I . Hence, $\ker(\varphi)$ is trivial and is then injective. $\square$

1.7 Group Actions

- (1) Let F be a field. Show that the multiplicative group of nonzero elements of F (denoted by $F^\times$) acts on the set F by $g \cdot a = ga$, where $g \in F^\times$, $a \in F$ and ga is the usual product in F of the two field elements (state clearly which axioms in the definition of a field are used).

Solution. Suppose $g, h \in F^\times$. Then for any $a \in A$, we have

$$g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot (ha) = \underbrace{g(ha)}_{\text{Associativity}} = (gh)a = (gh) \cdot a$$

Moreover, $1 \cdot a = 1a = a$ by definition of $1 \in F^\times$. Lastly, note that $1(0) = 1(0+0) = 1(0) + 1(0)$. By cancellation, then $0 = 1(0) = 1 \cdot 0$ so that all $a \in F$ is accounted for. $\square$

- (2) Show that the additive group $\mathbb{Z}$ acts on itself by $z \cdot a = z + a$ for all $z, a \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Solution. Let $z, w \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$z \cdot (w \cdot a) = z \cdot (w + a) = z + (w + a) = (z + w) + a = (z + w) \cdot a$$

Moreover, $0 \cdot a = 0 + a = a$ so that $\cdot$ is a group action. $\square$

- (3) Show that the additive group $\mathbb{R}$ acts on the x, y plane $\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}$ by $r \cdot (x, y) = (x + r, y)$.

Solution. Suppose $r, s \in \mathbb{R}$. Then for any $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}$, we have

$$r \cdot (s \cdot (x, y)) = r \cdot (x + s, y) = ((x + s) + r, y) = (x + (r + s), y) = (r + s) \cdot (x, y)$$

Moreover, $0 \cdot (x, y) = (x + 0, y) = (x, y)$ so that $\cdot$ is a group action. $\square$

- (4) Let G be a group acting on a set A and fix some $a \in A$. Show that the following sets are subgroups of G (cf. Exercise 26 of Section 1):

- (a) the kernel of the action,
- (b) $\{g \in G \mid ga = a\}$ — this subgroup is called the *stabilizer* of a in G .

Solution.

- (a) Recall that $\ker(\cdot) = \{g \in G \mid g \cdot a = a \text{ for all } a \in A\}$. Suppose $g, h \in \ker(\cdot)$. Then for any $a \in A$, we have

$$(gh) \cdot a = g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot a = a$$

so that $gh \in \ker(\cdot)$. Moreover,

$$a = 1 \cdot a = (g^{-1}g) \cdot a = g^{-1}(g \cdot a) = g^{-1} \cdot a$$

so that $g^{-1} \in \ker(\cdot)$. Then $\ker(\cdot)$ is closed under the operation of G and inverses so that it is a subgroup of G .

- (b) Let $a \in A$ be fixed, and let H be as described. Note that $1 \in H$ so that it is nonempty. Suppose $g, h \in H$. Then

$$(gh) \cdot a = g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot a = a$$

so that $gh \in H$. Moreover,

$$a = 1 \cdot a = (g^{-1}g) \cdot a = g^{-1} \cdot (g \cdot a) = g^{-1} \cdot a$$

so that $g^{-1} \in H$. Then H is closed under the operation of G and inverses, hence it is a subgroup of G . $\square$

- (5) Prove that the kernel of an action of the group G on the set A is the same as the kernel of the corresponding permutation representation $G \rightarrow S_A$ (cf. Exercise 14 in Section 6).

Solution. Let $\ker(\cdot)$ be the kernel of the action and $\varphi : G \rightarrow S_A$ be the permutation representation so that $\varphi(g)(a) = g \cdot a$. Let $g \in \ker(\cdot)$. Then $\varphi(g)(a) = g \cdot a = a$ so that $g \in \ker(\varphi)$. If $g \in \ker(\varphi)$, then $\varphi(g) = 1 \in S_A$, or the identity permutation. It follows that $\varphi(g)(a) = 1(a) = g \cdot a$ so that $g \in \ker(\cdot)$. It follows that $\ker(\cdot) = \ker(\varphi)$. $\square$

- (6) Prove that a group G acts faithfully on a set A if and only if the kernel of the action is the set consisting only of the identity.

Solution. Suppose G acts faithfully on a set A , and pick $g \in \ker(\cdot)$. Then $g \cdot a = a$ for every $a \in A$. But $1 \cdot a = a$ as well. Since the action is faithful, it must be that $g = 1$ so that $\ker(\cdot) = \{1\}$.

Suppose now that $\ker(\cdot) = \{1\}$, and pick some $g, h \in G$ such that $g \cdot a = h \cdot a$ for any $a \in A$. Then

$$a = (g^{-1}g) \cdot a = g^{-1} \cdot (g \cdot a) = g^{-1} \cdot (h \cdot a) = (g^{-1}h) \cdot a$$

so that $g^{-1}h \in \ker(\cdot)$. Then $g^{-1}h = 1$, or $g = h$. Hence, G acts on A faithfully. $\square$

- (7) Prove that in Example 2 in this section the action is faithful.

Solution. Let V be a vector space with a field F . For any $v \in V$ and $r \in F^\times$, let the group action be defined as $r \cdot v = r v$. Now suppose $r \cdot v = s \cdot v$ for some $r, s \in F^\times$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{0} &= \mathbf{0} \cdot v = a \cdot v + (-a) \cdot v \\ &= b \cdot v + (-a) \cdot v \\ &= (b + (-a)) \cdot v \\ &= (b - a)v \end{aligned}$$

Since $(b - a)v = \mathbf{0}$ even for $v \neq \mathbf{0}$, it must be that $b - a = 0$, or $b = a$. Then the action is faithful. $\square$

- (8) Let A be a nonempty set and let k be a positive integer with $k \leq |A|$. The symmetric group S_A acts on the set B consisting of all subsets of A of cardinality k by

$$\sigma(\{a_1, \dots, a_k\}) = \{\sigma(a_1), \dots, \sigma(a_k)\}.$$

- (a) Prove that this is a group action.
 (b) Describe explicitly how the elements $(1\ 2)$ and $(1\ 2\ 3)$ act on the six 2-element subsets of $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$.

Solution.

- (a) Let $\sigma, \tau \in S_A$. Then for any cardinality k subset $\{x_1, \dots, x_k\}$ of A , we have

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma \cdot (\tau \cdot \{x_1, \dots, x_k\}) &= \sigma \cdot \{\tau(x_1), \dots, \tau(x_k)\} \\ &= \{\sigma(\tau(x_1)), \dots, \sigma(\tau(x_k))\} \\ &= (\sigma \circ \tau) \cdot \{x_1, \dots, x_k\} \end{aligned}$$

Moreover, $1 \cdot \{x_1, \dots, x_k\} = \{1(x_1), \dots, 1(x_k)\} = \{x_1, \dots, x_k\}$. Then it is a group action.

- (b)

A	$(1\ 2) \cdot A$	$(1\ 2\ 3) \cdot A$
$\{1, 2\}$	$\{2, 1\}$	$\{2, 3\}$
$\{1, 3\}$	$\{2, 3\}$	$\{2, 1\}$
$\{1, 4\}$	$\{2, 4\}$	$\{2, 4\}$
$\{2, 3\}$	$\{1, 3\}$	$\{3, 1\}$
$\{2, 4\}$	$\{1, 4\}$	$\{3, 4\}$
$\{3, 4\}$	$\{3, 4\}$	$\{1, 4\}$

$\square$

- (9) Do both parts of the preceding exercise with “ordered k -tuples” in place of “ k -element subsets,” where the action on k -tuples is defined as above but with set braces replaced by parentheses (note that, for example, the 2-tuples $(1, 2)$ and $(2, 1)$ are different even though the sets $\{1, 2\}$ and $\{2, 1\}$ are the same, so the sets being acted upon are different).

Solution. The work is similar as above, except there are 12 2-tuples as $(1, 2) \neq (2, 1)$. $\square$

- (10) With reference to the preceding two exercises determine:

- (a) for which values of k the action of S_n on k -element subsets is faithful, and
 (b) for which values of k the action of S_n on ordered k -tuples is faithful.

Solution.

- (a) for $k = |A|$, the action is not faithful: if there exist a subset $S \subseteq A$ such that $|S| = |A|$, then $S = A$. Then if we have any distinct permutations $\sigma, \tau \in S_A$, then $\sigma \cdot S = S = \tau \cdot S$.

To that end, suppose we have a subset S of cardinality k where $1 \leq k < |A|$, and let $\sigma, \tau \in S_A$ such that $\sigma \neq \tau$. Let $A = \{a_1, \dots, a_n\}$ such that $\sigma(a_i) \neq \tau(a_i)$ for any such a_i . Let $S \subset A$ have cardinality k such that $(\sigma^{-1} \circ \tau)(a_i) \notin S$ and $a_i \in S$, where such an element exists since S is a proper subset of A . Then $\sigma(a_i) \notin \sigma \cdot S$, but $\tau(a_i) \in S$ so that distinct permutations are induced on S . Then the action of S_A on A is faithful for all k where $1 \leq k < |A|$.

(b) Let $1 \leq k \leq |A|$ and consider the k -tuple $(a_1, \dots, a_k)$. Let $\sigma, \tau \in S_A$ such that $\sigma \neq \tau$. Then there is some $a_i \in A$ where $\sigma(a_i) \neq \tau(a_i)$. Then $\sigma \cdot (a_1, \dots, a_k) \neq \tau \cdot (a_1, \dots, a_k)$ so that they induce different permutations on the k -tuples. Hence, the action is faithful. $\square$

- (11) Write out the cycle decomposition of the eight permutations in S_4 corresponding to the elements of D_8 given by the action of D_8 on the vertices of a square (where the vertices of the square are labeled as in Section 2).

Solution. Let $\varphi : D_8 \rightarrow S_4$ be the permutation representation of the action of D_8 on the vertices of a square $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi(1) &= 1 \\ \varphi(r) &= (1\ 2\ 3\ 4) \\ \varphi(r^2) &= (1\ 3)(2\ 4) \\ \varphi(r^3) &= (1\ 4\ 3\ 2) \\ \varphi(s) &= (2\ 4) \\ \varphi(sr) &= (1\ 4)(2\ 3) \\ \varphi(sr^2) &= (1\ 3) \\ \varphi(sr^3) &= (1\ 2)(3\ 4)\end{aligned}$$

$\square$

- (12) Assume n is an even positive integer and show that D_{2n} acts on the set consisting of pairs of opposite vertices of a regular n -gon. Find the kernel of this action (label vertices as usual).

Solution. Let P_k denote the pair of opposite vertices. In particular, define it as the set

$$P_k := \{k, k + n/2\}$$

Moreover, let $P = \{P_1, P_2, \dots, P_{n/2}\}$. Define a mapping $D_{2n} \times P \rightarrow P$ as $r \cdot P_k = r(P_k) = P_m$, where P_m consists of the vertices that r maps the vertices in P_k to.

By definition, for any $x, y \in D_{2n}$, then $x \cdot (y \cdot P_k) = x \cdot (y(P_k)) = x(y(P_k)) = (xy)(P_k)$. Moreover, $1(P_k) = P_k$ since 1 fixes all vertices in the n -gon so that the mapping is a group action. Since no action in D_{2n} fixes some vertices and sends others to other vertices except 1 and $r^{n/2}$, the only candidates for the kernel of this group action is the identity and the 180° rotation, or $r^{n/2}$. Note that for $n = 2$, then s and sr^2 are also in the kernel. $\square$

- (13) Find the kernel of the left regular action.

Solution. See item 3 in Definition 1.22 for the solution. $\square$

- (14) Let G be a group and let $A = G$. Show that if G is non-abelian then the maps defined by

$$g \cdot a = ag \quad \text{for all } g, a \in G$$

do not satisfy the axioms of a (left) group action of G on itself.

Solution. Since G is non-abelian, there exists $g, h \in G$ such that $gh \neq hg$. Assuming that the above is a group action, then it must be that

$$g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot (ah) = (ah)g = a(hg) = a(gh) = (gh) \cdot a$$

for any $a \in A$. Left cancelling results in $hg = gh$, contradicting that G is non-abelian. $\square$

- (15) Let G be any group and let $A = G$. Show that the maps defined by

$$g \cdot a = ag^{-1} \quad \text{for all } g, a \in G$$

do satisfy the axioms of a (left) group action of G on itself.

Solution. Let $g, h \in G$. Then for any $a \in A$, we have

$$g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot (ah^{-1}) = a(h^{-1}g^{-1}) = a(gh)^{-1} = (gh) \cdot a$$

Moreover, $1 \cdot a = a1^{-1} = a1 = a$. Then the above is a left group action. $\square$

- (16) Let G be any group and let $A = G$. Show that the maps defined by

$$g \cdot a = g a g^{-1} \quad \text{for all } g, a \in G$$

do satisfy the axioms of a (left) group action (this action of G on itself is called *conjugation*).

Solution. Let $g, h \in G$. For any $a \in A$, then

$$g \cdot (h \cdot a) = g \cdot (h a h^{-1}) = g(h a h^{-1})g^{-1} = (gh)a(gh)^{-1} = (gh) \cdot a$$

Moreover, $1 \cdot a = 1 a 1^{-1} = a$. Then it is a group action. $\square$

- (17) Let G be a group and let G act on itself by left conjugation, so each $g \in G$ maps G to G by

$$x \mapsto g x g^{-1}.$$

For fixed $g \in G$, prove that conjugation by g is an isomorphism from G onto itself (i.e. an automorphism of G). Deduce that x and $g x g^{-1}$ have the same order for all $x \in G$ and that for any subset A of G , $|A| = |g A g^{-1}|$ (here $g A g^{-1} = \{g a g^{-1} \mid a \in A\}$).

Solution. Let g be fixed and define the map

$$\varphi : G \rightarrow G \text{ where } x \mapsto g x g^{-1}$$

Then for $x, y \in G$, we have

$$\varphi(xy) = g(xy)g^{-1} = (g x g^{-1})(g y g^{-1}) = \varphi(x)\varphi(y)$$

so that φ is a homomorphism. Now suppose $\varphi(x) = \varphi(y)$. Then $g x g^{-1} = g y g^{-1}$. Cancellation shows that $x = y$ so that φ is injective. Finally, suppose $y \in G$ such that $\varphi(x) = y$. Then $g x g^{-1} = y$, or $x = g^{-1} y g \in G$. Then φ is surjective. It follows that φ is an automorphism of G and that $|x| = |g x g^{-1}|$ since isomorphisms preserve order. Moreover, for $A \subseteq G$, then $\varphi|_A : A \rightarrow g A g^{-1}$ is still a bijection so that $|A| = |g A g^{-1}|$. $\square$

- (18) Let H be a group acting on a set A . Prove that the relation $\sim$ on A defined by

$$a \sim b \quad \text{if and only if} \quad a = h b \text{ for some } h \in H$$

is an equivalence relation. (For each $x \in A$ the equivalence class of x under $\sim$ is called the orbit of x under the action of H . The orbits under the action of H partition the set A .)

Solution. Since $a = 1a$, then $a \sim a$. If $a \sim b$, then there exists some $h \in H$ where $a = hb$. Then $h^{-1}a = b$ so that $b \sim a$. Finally, if $a \sim b$ and $b \sim c$, there exists $h, h' \in H$ where $a = hb$ and $b = h'c$. Then $a = (hh')c$ so that $a \sim c$. Then $\sim$ is an equivalence relation. $\square$

- (19) Let H be a subgroup of the finite group G and let H act on G (here $A = G$) by left multiplication. Let $x \in G$ and let $\mathcal{O}$ be the orbit of x under this action of H . Prove that the map

$$H \rightarrow \mathcal{O}, \quad h \mapsto hx$$

is a bijection (hence all orbits have cardinality $|H|$). From this and the preceding exercise deduce *Lagrange's Theorem*:

$$\text{If } G \text{ is a finite group and } H \text{ is a subgroup of } G \text{ then } |H| \text{ divides } |G|$$

Solution. Let $\varphi : H \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$ be the mapping $h \mapsto hx$ for fixed $x \in G$. Suppose $\varphi(h) = \varphi(k)$ for $h, k \in H$. Then $hx = kx$, implying $h = k$. Surjectivity is given, so φ is a bijection. Then $|H| = |\mathcal{O}|$. The previous exercise shows that G is partitioned into the orbits under the action of H so that $|G| = n|H|$, where n represents the number of orbits. This is exactly Lagrange's Theorem. $\square$

- (20) Show that the group of rigid motions of a tetrahedron is isomorphic to a subgroup of S_4 .

Solution. Let G be the rigid motions of a tetrahedron, and let $A = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ be the set that G acts on. In particular, each $\alpha \in G$ is associated with a permutation σ_α of A such that $\alpha i = \sigma_\alpha(i)$.

Consider the injective map

$$\varphi : G \rightarrow S_4 \text{ where } \varphi(\alpha) = \sigma_\alpha$$

It is clear that $\varphi(G)$ is a subgroup of S_4 , and we may restrict S_4 to consider the elements from $\varphi(G)$ only to obtain an isomorphism. $\square$

- (21) Show that the group of rigid motions of a cube is isomorphic to S_4 . (This group acts on the set of four pairs of opposite vertices.)

Solution. As per [Section 2, Exercise 10](#), recall that $|G| = 24 = |S_4|$. Now let G be a group of rigid motions of a cube with $A = \{a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4\}$, where each a_i consists of a pair of opposing vertices of a cube. Clearly, each $\alpha \in G$ sends some a_i to another a_j so that G acts on A .

Consider now the homomorphism $\varphi : G \rightarrow S_4$ where $\varphi(\alpha)(a_i) = \alpha a_i$. Because each rigid motion is distinct, then this is injective. Then $G \cong S_4$. $\square$

- (22) Show that the group of rigid motions of an octahedron is isomorphic to a subgroup of S_4 . (This group acts on the set of four pairs of opposite faces.) Deduce that the groups of rigid motions of a cube and of an octahedron are isomorphic. (These two groups are isomorphic because these solids are “dual.”)

Solution. Let G be the group of rigid motions of an octahedron with $A = \{f_1, f_2, f_3, f_4\}$, where each f_i corresponds to opposing faces of an octahedron. Then $\alpha \in G$ sends some pair of faces to another pair of faces so that G acts on A .

As in the last exercise, consider the injective homomorphism $\varphi : G \rightarrow S_4$, where $\varphi(\alpha)(f_i) = \alpha f_i$. Since $|G| = 24$ from [Section 2, Exercise 11](#), it follows that $G \cong S_4$. Hence, G is isomorphic to the group of rigid motions of a cube. $\square$

- (23) Explain why the action of the group of rigid motions of a cube on the set of three pairs of opposite faces is not faithful. Find the kernel of this action.

Solution. The group of rigid motions of a cube has 24 elements, while permutations of the set of three pairs of opposing faces has 6 elements, so the action cannot be faithful as no homomorphism can be injective between finite groups of differing sizes (if there was some injective homomorphism, it would imply bijectivity between the two groups of differing cardinality, which is impossible).

Consider a cube such that its center is at the origin of $\mathbb{R}^3$ space. Then any rotation around the axes fixes a pair of faces, while sends the other two pairs back to themselves (to visualize this explicitly, consider the cube with vertices $(\pm 1, \pm 1, \pm 1)$ and the z -axis. A rotation around the z -axis would fix the faces $(\pm 1, \pm 1, 1)$ and $(\pm 1, \pm 1, -1)$, while it rotates the pair of faces $(1, \pm 1, \pm 1)$ and $(-1 \pm 1, \pm 1)$ back to each other—these are the faces that vary along the x -axis. One can construct the same for the pair of faces that lie along the y -axis and deduce the same thing). There are exactly 3 of these 180° rotations, so the kernel of this action consists of these rotations and the identity. $\square$

2 Subgroups

2.1 Definitions and Examples

(1) In each of (a)–(e) prove that the specified subset is a subgroup of the given group:

- (a) the set of complex numbers of the form $a + ai$, $a \in \mathbb{R}$ (under addition)
- (b) the set of complex numbers of absolute value 1, i.e., the unit circle in the complex plane (under multiplication)
- (c) for fixed $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ the set of rational numbers whose denominators divide n (under addition)
- (d) for fixed $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ the set of rational numbers whose denominators are relatively prime to n (under addition)
- (e) the set of nonzero real numbers whose square is a rational number (under multiplication)

Solution. Let G be the group in question and let H be the set that we are trying to prove is a subgroup of G .

- (a) Clearly $0 = 0 + 0i \in H$ so that H is nonempty. Suppose $a + ai, b + bi \in H$. Then $a - b \in \mathbb{R}$ so that $(a + ai) - (b + bi) = (a - b) + (a - b)i \in H$ so that $H \leq G$.
- (b) Since $|1| = 1$, then $1 \in H$ so that it is nonempty. Suppose $z, w \in H$. Note that $|w^{-1}| = 1$ since $|w^{-1}| = |\bar{w}|/|w|^2 = 1/1 = 1$. Then

$$|zw^{-1}| = |z||w^{-1}| = (1)(1) = 1$$

so that $zw^{-1} \in H$. Then $H \leq G$.

- (c) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ be fixed. Since $0 = 0/k$ where $k \mid n$, then $0 \in H$ so that it is nonempty. Suppose $a/b, c/d \in H$, where $(a, b) = (c, d) = 1$, and $br = ds = n$ for $r, s \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$\frac{a}{b} - \frac{c}{d} = \frac{ar}{n} - \frac{cs}{n} = \frac{ar - bs}{n}$$

After reduction, the denominator will still be a divisor of n , so $a/b - c/d \in H$, and $H \leq G$.

- (d) Fix $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, and note that $0 = 0/1 \in H$ so that H is nonempty. Suppose $a/b, c/d \in H$ such that $(b, n) = (d, n) = 1$. For any prime p such that $p \mid n$, then $p \nmid b$ and $p \nmid d$. Then

$$\frac{a}{b} - \frac{c}{d} = \frac{ad - bc}{bd}$$

Consider $x = (bd, n)$. Then $p \nmid x$, for otherwise $p \mid bd$ implying that $p \mid b$ or $p \mid d$. Then $x = 1$, and $a/b - c/d \in H$ so that $H \leq G$.

- (e) Since $1 = 1^2 = 1/1 \in H$, then H is nonempty. Suppose $a, b \in H$. Then $a^2, b^2 \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that

$$\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)^2 = \frac{a^2}{b^2} \in H$$

then $a/b \in H$, and $H \leq G$. □

(2) In each of (a)–(e) prove that the specified subset is *not* a subgroup of the given group:

- (a) the set of 2-cycles in S_n for $n \geq 3$
- (b) the set of reflections in D_{2n} for $n \geq 3$
- (c) for n a composite integer > 1 and G a group containing an element of order n , the set $\{x \in G \mid |x| = n\} \cup \{1\}$
- (d) the set of (positive and negative) odd integers in $\mathbb{Z}$ together with 0
- (e) the set of real numbers whose square is a rational number (under addition)

Solution. Let H be the set in question and G be the group.

- (a) Note that $(1\ 2), (1\ 3) \in H$, but $(1\ 2)(1\ 3) = (1\ 3\ 2) \notin H$.
- (b) $s, sr \in H$, but $s(sr) = r \notin H$ as r is not a reflection.
- (c) Let $p \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ such that $p \mid n$. Pick $x \in H$ so that $x^{n/p} \in H$. But $|x^{n/p}| < n$, since $(x^{n/p})^p = x^n = 1$, so H is not closed under the operation.

(d) $1 \in H$, but $1 + 1 = 2 \notin H$.

(e) $\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3} \in H$, but $(\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3})^2 = 2 + 2\sqrt{6} + 3 \notin H$, so $\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3} \notin H$. $\square$

(3) Show that the following subsets of the dihedral group D_8 are actually subgroups:

(a) $\{1, r^2, s, sr^2\}$

(b) $\{1, r^2, sr, sr^3\}$

Solution.

(a)

$\circ$	1	r^2	s	sr^2
1	1	r^2	s	sr^2
r^2	r^2	1	sr^2	s
s	s	sr^2	1	r^2
sr^2	sr^2	s	r^2	1

(b)

$\circ$	1	r^2	sr	sr^3
1	1	r^2	sr	sr^3
r^2	r^2	1	sr^3	sr
sr	sr	sr^3	1	r^2
sr^3	sr^3	sr	r^2	1

Both tables show closure, since no product is an element outside of the subset. $\square$

(4) Give an explicit example of a group G and an infinite subset H of G that is closed under the group operation but is not a subgroup of G .

Solution. Consider $\mathbb{Z}^+$ and $\mathbb{Z}$ under addition. Then $|\mathbb{Z}^+| = \infty$ and $m + n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ for any $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, but $m - n \notin \mathbb{Z}^+$ when $m < n$. Then $\mathbb{Z}^+$ is not a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$. $\square$

(5) Prove that G cannot have a subgroup H with $|H| = n - 1$, where $n = |G| > 2$.

Solution. Suppose that there did exist H such that $|H| = n - 1$. By Lagrange's Theorem, then $n - 1 \mid n$. Then there exists k such that $k(n - 1) = kn - k = n$, or that $n = k/(k - 1)$. Since $n > 2$, we may safely assume that $k > 2$. Since $n \notin \mathbb{Z}^+$ for any $k > 2$, this contradicts Lagrange's Theorem. $\square$

(6) Let G be an abelian group. Prove that $\{g \in G \mid |g| < \infty\}$ is a subgroup of G (called the torsion subgroup of G). Give an explicit example where this set is not a subgroup when G is non-abelian.

Solution. Let $\text{Tor}(G)$ denote the torsion subgroup of G . Since $|1| = 1$, then $1 \in \text{Tor}(G)$. Now suppose $g, h \in \text{Tor}(G)$, and put $|g| = m$ and $|h| = n$ for finite m, n . Then

$$(gh^{-1})^{mn} = g^{mn}(h^{-1})^{mn} = (g^m)^n((h^{-1})^n)^m = 1^n 1^m = 1$$

so that $gh^{-1} \in \text{Tor}(G)$. Then $\text{Tor}(G) \leq G$.

Now suppose $G = \text{Aut}(\mathbb{R})$ and consider $\text{Tor}(G) = \{f \in \text{Aut}(\mathbb{R}) \mid |f| < \infty\}$. Then $f(x) = -x$ and $g(x) = 1/x$ are both in $\text{Tor}(G)$, since $f^2(x) = g^2(x) = x$, but $f(g(x)) = -1/x \notin \text{Tor}(G)$, since $(f \circ g)^n(x) = (-1)^n x^{(-1)^n} \neq 1$ for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. $\square$

(7) Fix some $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $n > 1$. Find the torsion subgroup (cf. the previous exercise) of $\mathbb{Z} \times (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})$. Show that the set of elements of infinite order together with the identity is *not* a subgroup of this direct product.

Solution. Since every nonidentity element of $\mathbb{Z}$ has infinite order, then $\text{Tor}(\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}) = \{(0, x) \mid x \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}\}$, since every $x \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ has finite order as $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is finite. Moreover, if we let H be the set of elements of infinite order along with the identity $(0, 0)$, then $(1, 1), (-1, 0) \in H$, but $(1, 1) + (-1, 0) = (0, 1) \notin H$ because it belongs to the torsion subgroup. $\square$

(8) Let H and K be subgroups of G . Prove that $H \cup K$ is a subgroup if and only if either $H \subseteq K$ or $K \subseteq H$.

Solution. Suppose $H \cup K$ is a subgroup. If $H \subseteq K$, we are done. Now suppose $H \not\subseteq K$. Then there exists $h \in H$ such that $h \notin K$. Let $k \in K$. Then $hk \in H \cup K$. If $hk \in K$, then $hk(k^{-1}) = h \in K$, which is a contradiction. Then $hk \in H$. Then $h^{-1} \in H$ so that $h^{-1}(hk) = k \in H$ so that $K \subseteq H$.

If $H \subseteq K$ then $H \cup K = K$. If $K \subseteq H$, then $H \cup K = H$, both of which are subgroups of G . The result follows. $\square$

- (9) Let $G = \text{GL}_n(F)$, where F is any field. Define

$$\text{SL}_n(F) = \{A \in \text{GL}_n(F) \mid \det(A) = 1\}$$

(called the special linear group). Prove that $\text{SL}_n(F) \leq \text{GL}_n(F)$.

Solution. Since $\det(I_n) = 1$, then $I_n \in \text{SL}_n(F)$ so that $\text{SL}_n(F)$ is nonempty. Suppose $A, B \in \text{SL}_n(F)$. Then

$$\det(AB^{-1}) = \det(A)\det(B^{-1}) = \frac{\det(A)}{\det(B)} = \frac{1}{1} = 1$$

so that $AB^{-1} \in \text{SL}_n(F)$. It follows that $\text{SL}_n(F) \leq \text{GL}_n(F)$. $\square$

- (10) (a) Prove that if H and K are subgroups of G then so is their intersection $H \cap K$.
 (b) Prove that the intersection of an arbitrary nonempty collection of subgroups of G is again a subgroup of G (do not assume the collection is countable).

Solution.

- (a) Put $L = H \cap K$. Since $1 \in H$ and $1 \in K$, then $1 \in L$ so that L is nonempty. Pick $a, b \in L$. Then $a, b \in H$ and $a, b \in K$. Then $ab^{-1} \in H$ and $ab^{-1} \in K$ so that $ab^{-1} \in L$, hence $L \leq G$.
 (b) Let H_i be a subgroup of G with i belonging to an indexing set I . Let

$$H = \bigcap_{i \in I} H_i$$

Since $1 \in H_i$ for all i , then $1 \in H$. Suppose $a, b \in H$. Then $a, b \in H_i$ so that $ab^{-1} \in H_i$ for all $i \in I$. It follows that $ab^{-1} \in H$, hence $H \leq G$. $\square$

- (11) Let A and B be groups. Prove that the following sets are subgroups of the direct product $A \times B$:

- (a) $\{(a, 1) \mid a \in A\}$
 (b) $\{(1, b) \mid b \in B\}$
 (c) $\{(a, a) \mid a \in A\}$, where we assume $B = A$ (called the diagonal subgroup)

Solution. Let C be the set in each part.

- (a) Since $1 \in A$, then $(1, 1) \in C$ so that C is nonempty. Suppose $(a_1, 1), (a_2, 1) \in C$ for $a_1, a_2 \in A$. Then $a_1 a_2^{-1} \in A$. Then

$$(a_1, 1)(a_2, 1)^{-1} = (a_1, 1)(a_2^{-1}, 1) = (a_1 a_2^{-1}, 1) \in C$$

so that $C \leq A \times B$.

- (b) See above proof, but suppose $(1, b_1), (1, b_2) \in C$ for $b_1, b_2 \in B$.
 (c) $1 \in A$ so $(1, 1) \in C$, and C is nonempty. For $a_1, a_2 \in A$, then $a_1 a_2^{-1} \in A$ so that

$$(a_1, a_1)(a_2, a_2)^{-1} = (a_1 a_2^{-1}, a_1 a_2^{-1}) \in C$$

so that $C \leq A^2$. $\square$

- (12) Let A be an abelian group and fix some $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Prove that the following sets are subgroups of A :

- (a) $\{a^n \mid a \in A\}$
 (b) $\{a \in A \mid a^n = 1\}$

Solution. Let B be the sets in question.

- (a) $1^n = 1$, so $1 \in B$. Suppose $a^n, b^n \in B$. Then

$$(a^n)(b^n)^{-1} = (a^n)(b^{-1})^n = (ab^{-1})^n$$

where the last equality follows, since A is abelian. Then $ab^{-1} \in B$, hence $B \leq A$.

- (b) $1^n = 1$, so $1 \in B$. Suppose $a, b \in B$. Then

$$(ab^{-1})^n = a^n(b^n)^{-1} = 1(1^{-1}) = 1$$

so that $ab^{-1} \in B$, and $B \leq A$. □

- (13) Let H be a subgroup of the additive group of rational numbers with the property that $1/x \in H$ for every nonzero element x of H . Prove that $H = 0$ or $\mathbb{Q}$.

Solution. Let $H \leq \mathbb{Q}$. Then $0 \in H$. If no other element is in H , then $H = 0$ and we are done. Suppose that $H \neq 0$ so that there exists $x = a/b \in H$. Moreover, we may take $x > 0$, because if $x < 0$, take $-x > 0$ instead since H has inverses. Note that $bx = a \in H$ so that $1/a \in H$. Then $a(1/a) = 1 \in H$. Then $\mathbb{Z} \subseteq H$, since we may use 1 to build every integer.

Now suppose $r \in \mathbb{Q}$, and put $r = p/q$ for $p, q \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $q \in H$ so that $1/q \in H$, hence $p(1/q) = r \in H$. Then $\mathbb{Q} \subseteq H$, and $H = \mathbb{Q}$. □

- (14) Show that $\{x \in D_{2n} \mid x^2 = 1\}$ is *not* a subgroup of D_{2n} (here $n \geq 3$).

Solution. Let H be the set in question. Then $s, sr \in H$, since $|s| = 2$, and $(sr)^2 = s(sr^{-1})r = 1$. But $s(sr) = r \notin H$, because $|r| \geq 3$. □

- (15) Let $H_1 \subseteq H_2 \subseteq \cdots$ be an ascending chain of subgroups of G . Prove that $\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} H_i$ is a subgroup of G .

Solution. Let $H = \bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} H_i$. Since $1 \in H_i$ for all i , then $1 \in H$ so that H is nonempty. Pick $a, b \in H$. Then $a \in H_i$ and $b \in H_j$ for some $i, j \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $a, b \in H_k$, where $k = \max(i, j)$. Then $ab^{-1} \in H_k$ so that $ab^{-1} \in H$, hence $H \leq G$. □

- (16) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ and let F be a field. Prove that the set $\{(a_{ij}) \in \text{GL}_n(F) \mid a_{ij} = 0 \text{ for all } i > j\}$ is a subgroup of $\text{GL}_n(F)$ (called the group of upper triangular matrices).

Solution. Let $\text{UT}_n(F)$ denote the set of $n \times n$ upper triangular matrices with entries from F . Since I_n has all 0s except the diagonal, then $I_n \in \text{UT}_n(F)$ so that $\text{UT}_n(F)$ is nonempty. Suppose $A, B \in \text{UT}_n(F)$. Since $A, B \in \text{GL}_n(F)$, then $\det(A)$ and $\det(B)$ are nonzero. Putting $AB = C = (c_{ij})$ it follows that $\det(C)$ is also nonzero. Note that

$$c_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} b_{kj}$$

Suppose $i > j$. Then if $i > k$, then $a_{ik} = 0$, and if $k > j$, then $b_{kj} = 0$ so that $c_{ij} = 0$, hence $C \in \text{UT}_n(F)$.

To show that $A^{-1} \in \text{UT}_n(F)$, put $D \in \text{UT}_n(F)$ such that $AD = DA = I_n$. Proceeding by induction, we show the case for $n = 2$: Consider the matrices

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ 0 & a_{22} \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} d_{11} & d_{12} \\ d_{21} & d_{22} \end{pmatrix}$$

such that $AD = I_2$. While we may solve for each d_{ij} explicitly, since $D \in \text{GL}_2(F)$, it must be that $d_{ii} \neq 0$, and $d_{12} \in F$, so it remains to show that $d_{21} = 0$. To that end, note that $a_{22}d_{21} = 0$. Since $a_{22} \neq 0$ (otherwise $\det(A) = 0$ and $A \notin \text{GL}_2(F)$), it must be that $d_{21} = 0$, hence $D \in \text{UT}_2(F)$. Suppose now that the inverse D of $A \in \text{GL}_n(F)$ is also upper triangular, and consider $A \in \text{UT}_{n+1}(F)$ and $D \in \text{GL}_{n+1}(F)$ such that $AD = DA = I_{n+1}$. Using block matrices, we may write this as

$$\begin{pmatrix} A_0 & \mathbf{a}_{12} \\ 0 & a_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} D_0 & \mathbf{d}_{12} \\ \mathbf{d}_{21}^T & d_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} D_0 & \mathbf{d}_{12} \\ \mathbf{d}_{21}^T & d_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} A_0 & \mathbf{a}_{12} \\ 0 & a_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} I_n & \mathbf{0}_{n \times 1} \\ \mathbf{0}_{n \times 1}^T & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

where $\mathbf{a}_{12}, \mathbf{d}_{12}, \mathbf{d}_{21}^T, \mathbf{0}_{n \times 1}^T$ are $n \times 1$ column vectors, and $a_{22}, d_{22} \in F$. We can see that $D_0 A_0 = I_n$ so that $D_0 \in \text{UT}_n(F)$ by assumption. Moreover, $a_{22} \mathbf{d}_{21}^T = \mathbf{0}_{n \times 1}^T$. Since $a_{22} \neq 0$ because $A \in \text{UT}_{n+1}(F)$, then $\mathbf{d}_{21}^T = \mathbf{0}_{n \times 1}^T$. By induction, then $D \in \text{UT}_{n+1}(F)$, hence the inverse of any upper triangular matrix is also upper triangular. □

- (17) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ and let F be a field. Prove that the set $\{(a_{ij}) \in \text{GL}_n(F) \mid a_{ij} = 0 \text{ for all } i > j, \text{ and } a_{ii} = 1 \text{ for all } i\}$ is a subgroup of $\text{GL}_n(F)$.

Solution. Let H be the set in question. Since the diagonal of I_n is only 1's, then $I_n \in H$. Suppose $A, B \in H$. By the previous exercise, $A, B \in \text{UT}_n(F)$, so it remains to show that $a_{ii} = b_{ii} = 1$ for all $1 \leq i \leq n$. Then

$$(AB)_{ii} = \sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} b_{ki}$$

Since $a_{ik} = 0$ for $k < i$ and $b_{ki} = 0$ for $k > i$, then the sum degrades to $a_{ii} b_{ii} = 1$. Then H is closed under multiplication. Moreover, suppose $D \in \text{UT}_n(F)$ such that $DA = I_n$. Then

$$1 = (DA)_{ii} = d_{ii} a_{ii}$$

where we use the above to collapse the ii -th term of DA . Then $d_{ii} = 1$, hence $D \in H$, and H is closed under inverses. Hence, $H \leq \text{GL}_n(F)$. $\square$

2.2 Centralizers and Normalizers, Stabilizers and Kernels

- (1) Prove that $C_G(A) = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}ag = a \text{ for all } a \in A\}$.

Solution. $g \in C_G(A)$ if and only if $gag^{-1} = a$ if and only if $a = g^{-1}ag$. $\square$

- (2) Prove that $C_G(Z(G)) = G$ and deduce that $N_G(Z(G)) = G$.

Solution. Recall that $C_G(Z(G)) = \{g \in G \mid gag^{-1} = a \text{ for all } a \in Z(G)\}$. Clearly $C_G(Z(G)) \subseteq G$. Now suppose $g \in G$ and pick $z \in Z(G)$. Then $gz = zg$, or $gzg^{-1} = z$. Then $g \in C_G(Z(G))$, hence $G \subseteq C_G(Z(G))$. It follows that $C_G(Z(G)) = G$. Moreover, because $G = C_G(Z(G)) \leq N_G(Z(G))$ and $N_G(Z(G)) \leq G$ by definition, then $N_G(Z(G)) = G$. $\square$

- (3) Prove that if A and B are subsets of G with $A \subseteq B$ then $C_G(B)$ is a subgroup of $C_G(A)$.

Solution. Pick $g \in C_G(B)$. Then $gbg^{-1} = b$ for all $b \in B$. In particular, $gag^{-1} = a$ for all $a \in A$ because $A \subseteq B$. Then $C_G(B) \subseteq C_G(A)$. Since $C_G(B)$ and $C_G(A)$ are subgroups of G , then $C_G(B) \leq C_G(A)$. $\square$

- (4) For each of S_3 , D_8 , and Q_8 compute the centralizers of each element and find the center of each group. Does Lagrange's Theorem (Section 1.7, Exercise 19) simplify your work?

Solution. Note that for any group G , then $C_G(1) = G$ since every element of G commutes with the identity. Now take $a = (1\ 2) \in S_3$. Note that $A = \{1, a\} \leq C_{S_3}(a)$ so that 2 divides $|C_{S_3}(a)|$ by Lagrange's Theorem. Similarly, $|C_{S_3}(a)|$ divides $6 = |S_3|$. Since $(1\ 3) \notin C_{S_3}(a)$ as $a(1\ 3) \neq (1\ 3)a$, and a and $(1\ 3)$ generate S_3 , then no other element of S_3 lies in $C_{S_3}(a)$, hence $C_{S_3}(a) = A$. One can use a similar argument to show that $C_{S_3}((1\ 3)) = \{1, (1\ 3)\}$ and $C_{S_3}((2\ 3)) = \{1, (2\ 3)\}$. Moving on to the 3-cycles of S_3 , let $a = (1\ 2\ 3)$ and consider $A = \{1, a, a^2\}$, where $a \neq a^2$ since $|a| = 3$. It similarly follows that $A \leq C_{S_3}(a)$ so that 3 divides $|C_G(A)|$ and again, $|C_G(a)|$ divides 6. Since $(1\ 2)a \neq a(1\ 2)$, then $(1\ 2) \notin C_{S_3}(a)$ so that $|C_{S_3}(a)| = 3$, and $C_{S_3}(a) = A$. Similarly, $C_{S_3}((1\ 3\ 2)) = \{1, (1\ 3\ 2), (1\ 2\ 3)\}$. Lastly, there is no element in S_3 that commutes with other elements of S_3 except for the identity, so $Z(S_3) = 1$.

The following are the centralizers for each element in D_8 :

$$\begin{aligned} C_{D_8}(r) &= \{1, r, r^2, r^3\} \\ C_{D_8}(r^2) &= D_8 \\ C_{D_8}(r^3) &= \{1, r, r^2, r^3\} \\ C_{D_8}(s) &= \{1, r^2, s, sr^2\} \\ C_{D_8}(sr) &= \{1, r^2, sr, sr^3\} \\ C_{D_8}(sr^2) &= \{1, r^2, s, sr^2\} \\ C_{D_8}(sr^3) &= \{1, r^2, sr, sr^3\} \end{aligned}$$

and $Z(D_8) = \{1, r^2\}$. Lastly, the centralizers of Q_8 are

$$\begin{aligned} C_{Q_8}(-1) &= Q_8 \\ C_{Q_8}(i) &= \{1, -1, i, -i\} \\ C_{Q_8}(-i) &= \{1, -1, i, -i\} \\ C_{Q_8}(j) &= \{1, -1, j, -j\} \\ C_{Q_8}(-j) &= \{1, -1, j, -j\} \\ C_{Q_8}(k) &= \{1, -1, k, -k\} \\ C_{Q_8}(-k) &= \{1, -1, k, -k\} \end{aligned}$$

and $Z(Q_8) = \{1, -1\}$. □

(5) In each of parts (a) to (c) show that for the specified group G and subgroup A of G , $C_G(A) = A$ and $N_G(A) = G$.

- (a) $G = S_3$ and $A = \{1, (1\ 2\ 3), (1\ 3\ 2)\}$.
- (b) $G = D_8$ and $A = \{1, s, r^2, sr^2\}$.
- (c) $G = D_{10}$ and $A = \{1, r, r^2, r^3, r^4\}$.

Solution.

- (a) Since A is generated by $(1\ 2\ 3)$, then $A \leq C_G(A)$. By Lagrange's Theorem, then 3 divides $|C_G(A)|$ and $|C_G(A)|$ divides 6. Since $(1\ 2) \notin C_G(A)$ because $(1\ 2)(1\ 2\ 3) \neq (1\ 2\ 3)(1\ 2)$, then $C_G(A) = A$.

Since $C_G(A) \leq N_G(A)$, check $(1\ 2)$:

$$(1\ 2)A(1\ 2) = \{(1\ 2)(1\ 2), (1\ 2)(1\ 2\ 3)(1\ 2), (1\ 2)(1\ 3\ 2)(1\ 2)\} = \{1, (1\ 3\ 2), (1\ 2\ 3)\} = A$$

so that $(1\ 2) \in N_G(A)$. Then $N_G(A) = G$, since $(1\ 2\ 3)(1\ 2) = (1\ 3)$.

- (b) Note that A is a subgroup so that $A \leq C_G(A)$. Then Lagrange's implies that 4 divides $|C_G(A)|$ and 8 divides $|C_G(A)|$. Since $r \notin C_G(A)$, then $|C_G(A)| = 4$ so that $C_G(A) = A$.

Take $r \in G$, so that

$$rAr^{-1} = \{r1r^{-1}, rsr^{-1}, rr^2r^{-1}, rsr^2r^{-1}\} = \{1, sr^2, r^2, s\} = A$$

so that $r \in N_G(A)$. Since $C_G(A) \leq N_G(A)$ and $N_G(A) \leq G$, then 4 divides $|N_G(A)|$ which divides 8. Then $N_G(A) = D_8$.

- (c) A is the subgroup of rotations, so 5 divides $|C_G(A)|$ which divides 10. Since $s \notin C_G(A)$ as it doesn't commute with rotations, then $C_G(A) = A$. Moreover,

$$sAs = \{s1s, srs, sr^2s, sr^3s, sr^4s\} = \{1, r^4, r^3, r^2, r\} = A$$

so that $s \in N_G(A)$, hence $N_G(A) = G$. □

(6) Let H be a subgroup of the group G .

- (a) Show that $H \leq N_G(H)$. Give an example to show that this is not necessarily true if H is not a subgroup.
- (b) Show that $H \leq C_G(H)$ if and only if H is abelian.

Solution.

- (a) Fix $h \in H$, and pick $x \in hHh^{-1}$. Then $hxx^{-1} \in H$ since H is closed under inverses and the operation. Moreover, if $x \in H$, then $x \in hHh^{-1}$ by definition so that $hHh^{-1} = H$, hence $h \in N_G(H)$ so that $H \leq N_G(H)$.

Consider the set $G = D_6$ and $H = \{1, r, s\}$. Then $rHr^{-1} = \{1, r, sr\}$ so that $r \notin N_G(H)$, hence $H \not\leq N_G(H)$.

- (b) Suppose $H \leq C_G(H)$, and consider any $g, h \in H$. In particular, $g \in G$ so that $ghg^{-1} = h$, or $gh = hg$. Then H is abelian.

If H was abelian, pick $h \in H$. Then for any $g \in H$, we have $hg = gh$, or $hgh^{-1} = g$. Then $h \in C_G(H)$, and $H \leq C_G(H)$. □

(7) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $n \geq 3$. Prove the following:

- (a) $Z(D_{2n}) = \{1\}$ if n is odd.
 (b) $Z(D_{2n}) = \{1, r^k\}$ if $n = 2k$.

Solution. Instead of solving each problem individually, we proceed as follows: First, we show that every element of $Z(D_{2n})$ must be a rotation. To that end, consider sr^k for some $0 \leq k < n$, and consider $r \in D_{2n}$. Then

$$sr^k r = r sr^k \implies sr^{k+1} = sr^{k-1}$$

so that $r^{k+1} = r^{k-1}$, or $r^2 = 1$, contradicting that $n \geq 3$. Then no reflection lies in $Z(D_{2n})$, hence every element of the center must be a rotation.

Since rotations commute with other rotations, it suffices to check whether an arbitrary rotation r^k commutes with s :

$$r^k s = s r^k \implies r^k s = r^{-k} s$$

so that $r^{2k} = 1$. Since $|r| = n$, then $n \mid 2k$. Hence, $r^k \in Z(D_{2n})$ if and only if $n \mid 2k$.

- (a) If n is odd, then $2 \nmid n$. Since $n \mid 2k$, it must be that $n \mid k$. Since $0 \leq k < n$, then $k = 0$ so that $Z(D_{2n}) = \{1\}$.
 (b) If $n = 2m$, then $2m \mid 2k$ implies that $m \mid k$. Then $k = 0$ or $k = m = n/2 < n$ so that $Z(D_{2n}) = \{1, r^m\}$. $\square$
- (8) Let $G = S_n$, fix an $i \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ and let $G_i = \{\sigma \in G \mid \sigma(i) = i\}$ (the stabilizer of i in G). Use group actions to prove that G_i is a subgroup of G . Find $|G_i|$.

Solution. Since $1(i) = i$, then $1 \in G_i$. Let $\sigma, \tau \in G_i$. Then

$$(\sigma \circ \tau^{-1}) \cdot i = \sigma \cdot (\tau^{-1} \cdot i) = \sigma \cdot (\tau^{-1}(i)) = \sigma \cdot i = \sigma(i) = i$$

where $\tau^{-1}(i) = i$ because $\tau \in S_n$ so that τ^{-1} exists. Then $\sigma \circ \tau^{-1} \in G_i$, hence $G_i \leq G$. Moreover, G_i is the set of permutations on $\{1, \dots, n\}$ such that i is fixed while every other integer may be moved, i.e., $n-1$ elements may be permuted. Hence, $G_i \cong S_{n-1}$ so that $|G_i| = (n-1)!$. $\square$

- (9) For any subgroup H of G and any nonempty subset A of G define $N_H(A)$ to be the set $\{h \in H \mid hAh^{-1} = A\}$. Show that $N_H(A) = N_G(A) \cap H$ and deduce that $N_H(A)$ is a subgroup of H (note that A need not be a subset of H).

Solution. Suppose $g \in N_H(A)$. By definition, $g \in H$. Moreover, $gAg^{-1} = A$ and that $g \in H \leq G$ implies that $g \in N_G(A)$. Hence, $g \in N_G(A) \cap H$.

Suppose $h \in N_G(A) \cap H$. Since $h \in N_G(A)$, then $hAh^{-1} = A$. Moreover, $h \in H$ implies that $h \in N_H(A)$. It follows that $N_H(A) = N_G(A) \cap H$. Since the intersection of two subgroups is a subgroup (see [Section 2.1, Exercise 10](#)), then $N_H(A) \leq H$. $\square$

- (10) Let H be a subgroup of order 2 in G . Show that $N_G(H) = C_G(H)$. Deduce that if $N_G(H) = G$ then $H \leq Z(G)$.

Solution. Since $|H| = 2$, then $H = \{1, h\}$ for some $h \in G$ where $|h| = 2$. Suppose $g \in N_G(H)$. Then $gHg^{-1} = \{gg^{-1}, ghg^{-1}\} = \{1, ghg^{-1}\} = H$. If $ghg^{-1} = 1$, then $h = 1$ which contradicts that $|H| = 2$. Then $ghg^{-1} = h$ so that $g \in C_G(H)$. From Definition 2.6, we see that $C_G(H) \leq N_G(H)$ so that $N_G(H) = C_G(H)$.

Now suppose $N_G(H) = G$. It follows that for any $g \in N_G(H) = G$, then $gHg^{-1} = H$. In particular, we have that $ghg^{-1} = h$ for any $h \in H$. Then $gh = hg$ so that $h \in Z(G)$. Hence, $H \leq Z(G)$. $\square$

- (11) Prove that $Z(G) \leq N_G(A)$ for any subset A of G .

Solution. Let $g \in Z(G)$. Then $ga = ag$ for any $a \in A$ so that $gag^{-1} = a$. Hence, $gAg^{-1} = A$ so that $Z(G) \leq N_G(A)$. $\square$

- (12) Let R be the set of all polynomials with integer coefficients in the independent variables x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4 i.e., the members of R are finite sums of elements of the form $ax_1^{r_1}x_2^{r_2}x_3^{r_3}x_4^{r_4}$ where a is any integer and $r_1, \dots, r_4$ are nonnegative integers. For example,

$$12x_1^5x_2^7x_4 - 18x_2^3x_3 + 11x_1^6x_2^3x_4^{23} \quad (*)$$

is a typical element of R . Each $\sigma \in S_4$ gives a permutation of $\{x_1, \dots, x_4\}$ by defining $\sigma \cdot x_i = x_{\sigma(i)}$. This may be extended to a map from R to R by defining

$$\sigma \cdot p(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4) = p(x_{\sigma(1)}, x_{\sigma(2)}, x_{\sigma(3)}, x_{\sigma(4)})$$

for all $p(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4) \in R$ (i.e., σ simply permutes the indices of the variables). For example, if $\sigma = (1\ 2)(3\ 4)$ and $p(x_1, \dots, x_4)$ is the polynomial in (*) above, then

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma \cdot p(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4) &= 12x_2^5 x_1^7 x_4 - 18x_1^3 x_4 + 11x_2^6 x_1 x_4^3 x_3^{23} \\ &= 12x_1^7 x_2^5 x_4 - 18x_1^3 x_4 + 11x_1 x_2^6 x_3^{23} x_4^3.\end{aligned}$$

- Let $p = p(x_1, \dots, x_4)$ be the polynomial in (*) above, let $\sigma = (1\ 2\ 3\ 4)$ and let $\tau = (1\ 2\ 3)$. Compute $\sigma \cdot p$, $\tau \cdot (\sigma \cdot p)$, $(\tau \circ \sigma) \cdot p$, and $(\sigma \circ \tau) \cdot p$.
- Prove that these definitions give a (left) group action of S_4 on R .
- Exhibit all permutations in S_4 that stabilize x_4 and prove that they form a subgroup isomorphic to S_3 .
- Exhibit all permutations in S_4 that stabilize the element $x_1 + x_2$ and prove that they form an abelian subgroup of order 4.
- Exhibit all permutations in S_4 that stabilize the element $x_1 x_2 + x_3 x_4$ and prove that they form a subgroup isomorphic to the dihedral group of order 8.
- Show that the permutations in S_4 that stabilizes the element $(x_1 + x_2)(x_3 + x_4)$ are exactly the same as those found in part (e). (The two polynomials appearing in parts (e) and (f) and the subgroup that stabilizes them will play an important role in the study of roots of quartic equations in Section 14.6.)

Solution.

- Note that $\tau \circ \sigma = (1\ 3\ 4\ 2)$ and $\sigma \circ \tau = (1\ 3\ 2\ 4)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma \cdot p &= 12x_1 x_2^5 x_3^7 - 18x_3^3 x_4 + 11x_1^{23} x_2^6 x_3^3 x_4^3 \\ \tau \cdot (\sigma \cdot p) &= 12x_1^7 x_2 x_3^5 - 18x_1^3 x_4 + 11x_1 x_2^{23} x_3^6 x_4^3 \\ (\tau \circ \sigma) \cdot p &= 12x_1^7 x_2 x_3^5 - 18x_1^3 x_4 + 11x_1 x_2^{23} x_3^6 x_4^3 \\ (\sigma \circ \tau) \cdot p &= 12x_1 x_3^5 x_4^7 - 18x_2 x_3^3 + 11x_1^{23} x_2^3 x_3^6 x_4\end{aligned}$$

- Note that $1 \cdot p = p$ for any $p \in R$. Let $\sigma, \tau \in S_4$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma \cdot (\tau \cdot p(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4)) &= \sigma \cdot p(x_{\tau(1)}, x_{\tau(2)}, x_{\tau(3)}, x_{\tau(4)}) \\ &= p(x_{\sigma(\tau(1))}, x_{\sigma(\tau(2))}, x_{\sigma(\tau(3))}, x_{\sigma(\tau(4))}) \\ &= (\sigma \circ \tau) \cdot p(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4)\end{aligned}$$

- To stabilize x_4 means that $\sigma(4) = 4$ which are the permutations: $1, (1\ 2), (1\ 3), (2\ 3), (1\ 2\ 3), (1\ 3\ 2)$. Note that these correspond to the elements of S_3 so that they are a subgroup of S_4 that is isomorphic to S_3 .
- If $\sigma \in S_{4_{x_1+x_2}}$, then $\sigma \cdot (x_1 + x_2) = x_1 + x_2$. This occurs in one of three ways: all digits are fixed, 1 and 2 get swapped, or 1 and 2 are the only digits fixed. The first is the identity permutation, the second are the permutations $(1\ 2)$ and $(1\ 2)(3\ 4)$, and the third is $(3\ 4)$. Since $(1\ 2)$ and $(3\ 4)$ are disjoint, they commute with each other and thus the subset $\{1, (1\ 2), (3\ 4), (1\ 2)(3\ 4)\}$ is an abelian subgroup of S_4 with order 4.
- To stabilize $x_1 x_2 + x_3 x_4$, note that the identity permutation does this. Another way is to maintain the product $x_3 x_4$ but interchange 1 and 2, or the permutation $(1\ 2)$. Analogously, $(3\ 4)$ is another permutation by interchanging 3 and 4 but fixing 1 and 2. Alternatively, we may also combine these two permutations as $(1\ 2)(3\ 4)$ so that both interchanges occur at the same time. The next way is to interchange the placement of the products themselves, i.e., $x_1 x_2$ in the place of $x_3 x_4$, and vice versa. We obtain two more permutations $(1\ 3)(2\ 4)$ and $(1\ 4)(2\ 3)$, where 1 takes the place of 3 and 2 the place of 4 in the first product, and the second is explained similarly. Lastly, we may perform these interchanges in one full action, which results in the permutations $(1\ 3\ 2\ 4)$ and $(1\ 4\ 2\ 3)$.

Now consider the mapping $\varphi : S_{4_{x_1 x_2 + x_3 x_4}} \rightarrow D_8$ given by the following:

$$\varphi((1\ 2)) = s \quad \text{and} \quad \varphi((1\ 3\ 2\ 4)) = r$$

Since $(1\ 2)^2 = (1\ 3\ 2\ 4)^4 = 1$ and $(1\ 2)(1\ 3\ 2\ 4) = (1\ 3\ 2\ 4)^{-1}(1\ 2)$, then φ is an isomorphism. $\square$

- Let n be a positive integer and let R be the set of all polynomials with integer coefficients in the independent variables $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$, i.e., the members of R are finite sums of elements of the form $a x_1^{r_1} x_2^{r_2} \cdots x_n^{r_n}$ where a is any integer and $r_1, \dots, r_n$ are nonnegative integers. For each $\sigma \in S_n$ define a map

$$\sigma : R \rightarrow R \quad \text{by} \quad \sigma \cdot p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) = p(x_{\sigma(1)}, x_{\sigma(2)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(n)})$$

Prove that this defines a (left) group action of S_n on R .

Solution. Clearly $1 \cdot p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) = p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$. Moreover, for $\sigma, \tau \in S_n$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma \cdot (\tau \cdot p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)) &= \sigma \cdot p(x_{\tau(1)}, x_{\tau(2)}, \dots, x_{\tau(n)}) \\ &= p(x_{\sigma(\tau(1))}, x_{\sigma(\tau(2))}, \dots, x_{\sigma(\tau(n))}) \\ &= (\sigma \circ \tau) \cdot p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)\end{aligned}$$

Then it is a group action on R . □

- (14) Let $H(F)$ be the Heisenberg group over the field F introduced in [Section 1.4, Exercise 11](#). Determine which matrices lie in the center of $H(F)$ and prove that $Z(H(F))$ is isomorphic to the additive group F .

Solution. Let $X, Y \in H(F)$ be written as

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad Y = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d & e \\ 0 & 1 & f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

where $X \in Z(H(F))$. Then $XY = YX$, implying that

$$XY = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a+d & af+b+e \\ 0 & 1 & c+f \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & d+a & dc+e+b \\ 0 & 1 & f+c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = YX$$

Comparing entries, it follows that $af = dc$. Since $d, e, f \in F$ are arbitrary, it follows that this only occurs when $a = c = 0$, for otherwise if at least one of a or c were nonzero, then set f or d to be nonzero respectively to not have equality. Then elements of $Z(H(F))$ must be of the form

$$Z(H(F)) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & x \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in H(F) \mid x \in F \right\}$$

Moreover, the mapping $\varphi : F \rightarrow Z(H(F))$ defined by

$$\varphi(x) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & x \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

is clearly an isomorphism, so $Z(H(F)) \cong F$. □